U. S. DEPARTMENT OF LABOR

JAMES J. DAVIS, Secretary

CHILDREN'S BUREAU

FIFTEENTH ANNUAL REPORT OF THE CHIEF OF THE CHILDREN'S BUREAU

TO THE SECRETARY OF LABOR

FISCAL YEAR
ENDED JUNE 30
1927

UNITED STATES
GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE
WASHINGTON
1927

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FIFTEENTH ANNUAL REPORT

OF THE

CHIEF OF THE CHILDREN'S BUREAU

UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF LABOR,
CHILDREN'S BUREAU,
Washington, September 15, 1927.

Hon. JAMES J. DAVIS,
Secretary of Labor.

SIR: I have the honor to transmit herewith the fifteenth annual report of the Children's Bureau, for the fiscal year July 1, 1926, to June 30, 1927.

The Children's Bureau has seven major divisions, as follows: Maternity and infant hygiene, child hygiene, industrial, social service, statistical, editorial, and general administrative. The maternity and infant-hygiene division administers the maternity and infancy act; the child-hygiene division is in charge of the bureau's research in the field of child health and assists the other divisions in the preparation of reports in which child health is a factor. The social-service division has for its field dependency, delinquency, and neglect of children, and the industrial division is responsible for studies relating to the employment of children, protective legislation for working children, and vocational guidance. The statistical, editorial, and general administrative divisions serve the other divisions of the bureau, the statistical division undertaking also some independent pieces of research. In the following pages the work of these several divisions is summarized.

MATERNITY AND INFANCY

Administration of the maternity and infancy act.

Cooperation of the States with the Children's Bureau under the Federal maternity and infancy act for the promotion of the welfare and hygiene of maternity and infancy has been extended during the past year. In addition to the 43 States and Hawaii that had been cooperating, the Legislature of Kansas accepted the provisions of the act on March 16, 1927, and that of Maine on April 12, 1927, so that a total of 45 States—all except Massachusetts, Connecticut, and Illinois—and the Territory of Hawaii were receiving benefits of the act at the beginning of the fiscal year, 1928.

The following table gives the amounts available and the total amounts accepted by the States from the appropriations for the

fiscal years 1922, 1923, 1924, 1925, 1926, and for 1927 up to June 30, 1927:

TABLE 1.—*Amounts available to States and Hawaii from Federal maternity and infancy funds and amounts accepted* [1]

[Statement as of June 30, 1927]

State	Maximum amounts available from 1922 appropriation [2]	Amounts accepted by States from 1922 appropriation	Maximum amounts available from 1923, 1924, 1925, 1926, and 1927 appropriations	Amounts accepted by States and Hawaii [3] from—				
				1923 appropriation	1924 appropriation	1925 appropriation	1926 appropriation	1927 appropriation [4]
	Dollars	*Dollars*	*Dollars*	*Dollars*	*Dollars*	*Dollars*	*Dollars*	*Dollars*
Total	477,500.00	316,554.02	[3]1,201,725.96	716,333.40	877,122.04	932,754.69	949,646.00	904,824.71
Alabama	10,297.56	10,297.56	25,836.95	25,836.95	25,836.95	25,836.95	25,836.95	25,836.95
Arizona	5,753.88	5,000.00	12,253.71	5,000.00	12,253.71	12,253.71	5,000.00	12,253.71
Arkansas	8,953.03	5,000.00	21,817.51	6,855.75	16,817.51	13,500.00	14,000.00	12,000.00
California	12,731.12	[5]	33,112.01	24,279.35	13,114.93	15,620.00	26,730.00	25,470.00
Colorado	7,119.83	5,000.00	16,337.20	9,976.99	9,999.33	9,999.37	10,000.00	10,000.00
Connecticut	8,114.75	8,114.75	19,311.48	9,655.74				
Delaware	5,503.10	5,503.10	11,504.01	11,504.01	11,504.01	11,504.01	11,504.01	11,504.01
Florida	7,184.90	5,000.00	16,531.72	8,621.28	16,531.72	16,531.72	16,531.72	16,531.72
Georgia	11,533.10	6,750.00	29,530.55	11,000.00	15,250.00	28,490.00	29,530.00	23,610.00
Hawaii			[3]11,725.96			11,725.96	9,934.37	5,000.00
Idaho	5,974.30	5,000.00	12,912.66	6,250.00	7,912.66	5,691.60	9,308.40	6,000.00
Illinois	19,631.03	[5]	53,739.10					
Indiana	11,611.07	8,199.09	29,763.62	24,995.00	26,250.00	25,750.00	25,000.00	25,000.00
Iowa	10,423.56	10,423.56	26,213.60	26,213.60	26,213.60	26,213.60	26,213.60	26,213.60
Kansas	8,991.51	8,991.51	21,932.52	12,097.33				16,800.00
Kentucky	10,452.00	10,452.00	26,298.64	26,298.64	26,298.64	26,298.64	26,298.64	26,298.64
Louisiana	9,057.50		22,129.80		17,590.60	22,127.79	22,129.80	22,129.80
Maine	6,732.66		15,179.77					5,000.00
Maryland	8,270.49	7,913.57	19,777.05	19,277.05	19,269.05	19,164.58	19,277.00	19,277.00
Massachusetts	13,691.06		35,981.70					
Michigan	13,276.07	13,253.97	34,741.11	34,741.11	34,741.11	34,741.11	34,741.11	34,741.11
Minnesota	10,385.44	10,385.44	26,099.65	26,099.65	26,099.65	26,099.65	26,099.65	26,099.65
Mississippi	9,039.70	9,039.70	22,076.58	22,076.58	22,076.58	22,076.58	22,076.58	22,076.58
Missouri	12,679.67	12,473.15	32,958.19	28,527.38	21,762.17	24,000.00	25,600.00	32,958.19
Montana	6,238.31	6,238.31	13,701.91	13,701.91	13,701.91	13,701.91	13,700.00	13,700.00
Nebraska	7,924.66	7,924.66	18,743.21	17,661.69	7,409.50	11,915.00	12,980.00	11,000.00
Nevada	5,174.63	5,000.00	10,522.06	5,000.00	10,522.00	10,522.00	10,522.00	10,522.00
New Hampshire	5,999.61	5,000.00	12,988.31	5,000.00	12,988.31	12,988.31	12,988.31	12,988.31
New Jersey	12,119.83	12,119.83	31,284.55	31,284.55	31,284.55	31,284.55	31,284.55	31,284.55
New Mexico	5,812.96	5,812.96	12,430.33	12,430.33	12,236.40	12,430.33	12,430.33	12,430.33
New York	28,429.76		80,041.78		80,041.78	80,041.78	80,041.78	80,041.78
North Carolina	10,773.47	10,773.47	27,259.66	27,259.66	27,259.66	27,259.66	27,259.66	27,259.66
North Dakota	6,459.36	5,000.00	14,362.74	6,000.00	6,000.00	8,300.00	8,300.00	6,500.00
Ohio	17,993.41	7,187.95	48,843.46	11,900.00	17,297.89	26,606.96	31,400.73	5,000.00
Oklahoma	9,575.88	5,000.00	23,679.48	5,000.00	20,934.06	23,679.17	23,679.48	23,679.48
Oregon	6,767.35	6,232.61	15,283.46	8,000.00	15,283.46	15,283.46	12,395.87	15,283.46
Pennsylvania	24,672.69	24,667.12	68,810.99	68,810.20	68,810.99	68,810.99	68,810.99	68,810.99
Rhode Island	6,363.54		14,076.28		4,999.86	14,076.28	14,076.28	14,076.28
South Carolina	8,798.54	8,797.50	21,355.65	21,355.65	21,355.65	21,355.47	21,355.65	21,355.65
South Dakota	6,436.07	6,436.07	14,293.11	12,844.24	14,272.92	13,451.18	14,293.11	5,000.00
Tennessee	10,274.35	5,000.00	25,767.55	18,521.94	22,410.73	25,767.55	25,767.55	24,795.00
Texas	15,520.41	9,363.93	41,450.52	32,567.38	40,689.20	40,447.84	35,350.52	35,350.52
Utah	6,013.85	5,000.00	13,030.89	6,365.00	13,000.00	13,000.00	13,000.00	13,000.00
Vermont	5,795.09	[5]	12,376.90		2,775.33	4,281.36	5,000.00	5,000.00
Virginia	10,209.61	10,209.61	25,574.00	25,574.00	25,574.00	25,574.00	25,574.00	25,574.00
Washington	8,060.58	4,998.70	19,149.55	10,000.00	10,000.00	10,000.00	10,000.00	5,000.00
West Virginia	8,302.16	5,000.00	19,871.74	5,000.00	10,000.00	10,000.00	19,871.74	19,871.74
Wisconsin	10,938.04	8,995.03	27,751.62	27,750.44	27,751.62	27,751.62	27,751.62	5,000.00
Wyoming	5,438.57	4,998.87	11,311.12	5,000.00	11,000.00	6,600.00	6,600.00	7,500.00

[1] Under the terms of the act each State accepting receives $5,000 outright; an additional $5,000 is available to each State if matched; the balance of the appropriation is distributed among the States, if matched, on the basis of population. Amounts shown as accepted are the amounts actually accepted by the States less refunds of unexpended balances returned to the Federal Treasury as of June 30, 1927.

[2] Owing to the fact that only a few months of the 1922 fiscal year remained at the time the appropriation act for that year was passed a full appropriation was not made.

[3] The benefits of the act were extended to Hawaii on Mar. 10, 1924. No appropriation therefore was available to that Territory in 1923 and 1924. The total amount available to the States in each year from 1923 to 1927 has been $1,190,000.

[4] These funds are available until July 1, 1928. Actual acceptances up to June 30, 1927, are here given.

[5] California and Illinois accepted the full amount available, and Vermont accepted $5,000. However, these funds were not spent but were returned to the Federal Treasury.

Reports from the States show that during the fiscal year 1927 in 44 States[1] and the Territory of Hawaii 1,808 combined prenatal and child-health conferences were held, 21,347 child-health conferences, and 3,231 prenatal conferences. The number of expectant mothers reached through conferences, literature, home visits, and class work in the 38 States reporting was approximately 161,000. The number of infants and preschool children reached through similar efforts to promote their welfare and hygiene in the 39 States reporting and Hawaii was approximately 1,034,000. The number of counties having maternity and infancy work in 44 States and the Territory of Hawaii was 1,884.

Increased interest on the part of communities and a greater sense of local responsibility for the welfare of maternity and infancy have resulted in the development of more permanent local agencies. The number of combined prenatal and child-health centers established in 1927 was 70, of child-health centers 235, and of prenatal centers 14. The number of county public-health nurses employed on a full-time or part-time basis for maternity and infancy work was 354. The number of counties taking over maternity and infancy work initiated or assisted by the States was 69.

The fourth annual conference of the State directors of maternity and infant hygiene was held at the Children's Bureau January 11–14, 1927. Representatives were present from 37 of the cooperating States and the Territory of Hawaii and from 3 noncooperating States. In addition to the directors, the State supervising nurses were invited to the conference, and many came. State health officers from 5 States also attended the conference, making a total of 63 representatives in attendance from 40 States and the Territory of Hawaii. Representatives from the consulting obstetrical committee of the Children's Bureau attended the conference and took part in the program and discussions. Through the courtesy of the State director for Maryland and of the medical school of Johns Hopkins University the members of the conference spent a day in Baltimore visiting the Maryland State Department of Health, the pediatric clinics and lectures at Harriet Lane Home, Johns Hopkins Hospital, and the nutrition laboratories of Johns Hopkins Medical School.

Members of the staff of the maternity and infant-hygiene division of the bureau have visited the States to confer with the State directors and to see the work being done in different sections of the States. The bureau accountant, as usual, has audited the State accounts.

At the request of the States, members of the Children's Bureau staff have been detailed for assistance on special pieces of work in 28 States, as follows: Child-health conferences in 3 States, instruction of midwives in 2 States, graduate obstetrical course for physicians in 2 States, investigation of maternal mortality in 2 States, statistical analysis of maternity and infancy work in 11 States, and a survey of infant and maternity homes in 1 State. In cooperation

[1] Maine did not begin work under the act until July 1, 1927, the beginning of the fiscal year 1928. Kansas began May 1, 1927.

with the Bureau of the Census and the National "Committee to Aid Completion of the Registration Area before 1930," the Children's Bureau has given special assistance in promoting birth registration during the past year. To this end the bureau has detailed members of the bureau staff to 7 States not in the birth-registration area. During the year 4 new States (Idaho, Arizona, Arkansas, and Tennessee) entered the area, making 37 States in the birth-registration area at the end of the fiscal year. Of the 11 States outside the area, Nevada and South Dakota had not yet adopted the model birth registration law, while in Alabama,[2] Colorado, Georgia, Louisiana,[2] Missouri,[2] New Mexico, Oklahoma, South Carolina, and Texas admission to the area awaited demonstration that 90 per cent of all births were in fact being registered.[2]

The consulting obstetrical committee of the bureau has been of great help during the past year in working out a plan for a study of maternal mortality. With the cooperation of the respective State departments of health and the State medical societies, the investigation has been begun in three States, and in four other States plans for beginning the study in the near future are under way.

Infant mortality in the District of Columbia.

A survey of infant mortality in the District of Columbia has been undertaken at the request of the Council of Social Agencies and with the cooperation of the health officer of the District. Effort will be directed toward ascertaining the problems underlying infant mortality. The statistical base of the report will be birth certificates of 1925 and infant death certificates of 1925 and 1926. The adequacy of present provision for visiting and educational nursing and medical care and the distribution of prenatal and child-health clinics and hospital facilities will be studied.

Infant and maternal mortality rates.

Final figures are not yet available for the year 1926, but nearly complete returns indicate a slightly higher infant mortality rate (73) for that year, which is, however, 3 points lower than for the area in 1921 (76). Fluctuations in the rates from year to year make comparisons for single years of little value, and the expansion of the birth-registration area by the admission of new States affects the rates for the area as a whole. In the following table rates for States which accepted the maternity and infancy act prior to 1924, and which had been in the birth-registration area for three consecutive years prior to the acceptance of the act, are compared for the periods 1919 to 1921, inclusive, and 1922 to 1925, inclusive:

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[2] Alabama, Louisiana, and Missouri have been admitted to the birth-registration area since July 1, 1927, making 40 States now in the area.

TABLE 2.—*Comparison of infant mortality prior to period of cooperation under Sheppard-Towner Act with infant mortality during the period of cooperation; State, urban, and rural average rates for three and four year periods for specified States* [1]

State	State		Urban		Rural	
	1919–1921, inclusive	1922–1925, inclusive	1919–1921, inclusive	1922–1925, inclusive	1919–1921, inclusive	1922–1925, inclusive
California	70.3	69.9	64.1	63.3	78.8	79.3
Indiana	77.2	67.9	87.6	75.6	70.1	61.8
Kentucky	71.7	68.9	87.4	83.6	69.1	66.0
Maryland	100.9	91.2	96.4	86.5	106.7	97.4
Michigan	86.5	75.6	92.4	80.0	79.6	69.7
Minnesota	63.9	59.1	65.7	59.7	63.0	58.8
New Hampshire	89.1	82.1	97.4	89.8	80.1	73.9
New York [2]	79.6	69.6	80.7	69.6	74.7	69.7
North Carolina	81.1	80.4	108.4	102.8	78.2	77.0
Ohio	82.2	70.6	85.9	73.0	77.3	67.2
Oregon	58.3	55.1	59.0	52.8	57.8	56.6
Pennsylvania	94.8	84.7	94.4	84.2	95.1	85.2
South Carolina	108.0	[3] 97.0	138.4	[3] 114.0	104.7	[3] 94.9
Utah	71.8	62.1	70.7	59.7	72.3	63.4
Virginia	84.2	79.8	102.6	95.5	79.2	75.5
Washington [2]	61.2	56.4	59.3	50.9	63.0	62.2
Wisconsin	76.0	68.2	87.2	73.1	69.0	64.7

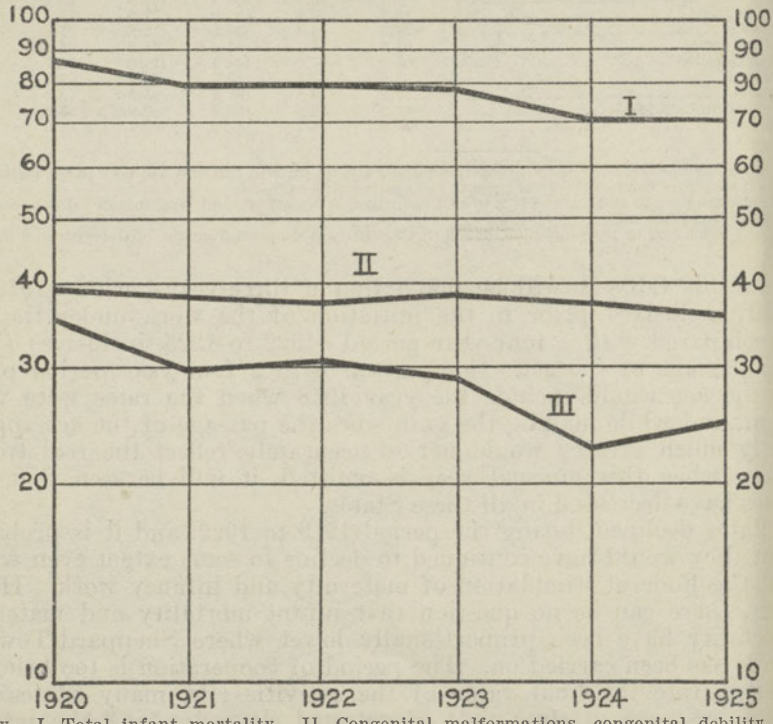
[1] States included were those that cooperated under the act prior to 1924 and had been in the birth-registration area three consecutive years prior to cooperation under the act.
[2] Rates are for 1920 to 1922, and 1923 to 1925, inclusive, as New York and Washington did not cooperate under the act until 1923.
[3] Rate is for 1922 to 1924, inclusive, as South Carolina was dropped from the birth-registration area in 1925.

In this table it will be noted that a three-year period (1919 to 1921, inclusive) prior to the initiation of the work under the act is compared with a four-year period (1922 to 1925, inclusive) since the passage of the act. Comparison with a four-year period prior to the act would include the year 1918 when the rates were very high, and while making the gain since the passage of the act apparently much greater would not so accurately reflect the real trend. Even when this unusual year is omitted, it will be seen that the rates have decreased in all these States.

Rates declined during the period 1919 to 1922, and it is probable that they would have continued to decline to some extent even without the Federal stimulation of maternity and infancy work. However, there can be no question that infant mortality and maternal mortality have been proportionally lower where Sheppard-Towner work has been carried on. The period of cooperation is too brief to demonstrate the final value of the activities; in many States the work has been of state-wide educational character, and the results will not be generally demonstrated by reduced infant and maternal mortality rates for a number of years. In States which have had intensive programs in limited areas, however, definite results can already be shown. For example, in a group of counties in central Wisconsin in which infants were examined at infant-welfare centers the average rate was 57.8 for a four-year period (1923 to 1926, inclusive) as compared with 65.9 for the years 1919 to 1922, before the work was initiated. In similar counties in central Wisconsin where itinerant conferences were held but intensive maternity and infancy work was not done the decline in infant mortality was less—from 73.5 to 68.2. Considering deaths from the second to the twelfth month of life, which much more accurately reflects the value of the

work since infants are not usually received at the infant-welfare centers during their first month of life, the rate for the period 1923 to 1926 was 7.1 per cent lower than that of the previous period (1919 to 1922) in these counties where intensive work of this kind was done, as compared with 2.6 per cent lower in counties in which permanent centers were not established. In two groups of counties in southern Wisconsin the rate from the second to the twelfth month of life from 1923 to 1926 in counties in which maternity and infancy work was done was 28.9 per cent lower than from 1919 to 1922, as compared with 9.8 per cent lower in counties in which the State did only general educational work.

DEATHS UNDER ONE YEAR PER 1,000 LIVE BIRTHS, BY CAUSE, NEW YORK STATE, EXCLUSIVE OF NEW YORK CITY, 1920–1925



KEY.—I. Total infant mortality. II. Congenital malformations, congenital debility, premature birth, injuries at birth. III. Communicable diseases, respiratory diseases, gastrointestinal diseases

New York State has had an extensive and varied program since the acceptance of the act in 1923. The accompanying graph supplied by the division of vital statistics of the New York State Department of Health shows the trend of infant mortality for certain groups of causes from 1920 to 1925. Infant mortality on the whole has decreased. A marked decline is apparent in the rate for communicable, respiratory, and gastrointestinal diseases combined, and a slight decrease is shown in the rate for the group composed of congenital malformations, premature birth, congenital debility, and injuries at birth. Deaths from this latter group of causes usually

occur in the first month of life. This reduction is most encouraging as the rate from these causes had been practically stationary for a number of years.

In Maryland work has been carried on in all sections of the State outside Baltimore, and reductions have been effected in infant and maternal mortality rates for both the white and the colored race. The maternal mortality rates of Maryland, exclusive of Baltimore, show an average annual reduction since 1921 of 8.9 per cent for the white and 3 per cent for the colored. The maternal mortality rates (deaths from puerperal causes per 10,000 live births) for Maryland, exclusive of Baltimore, from 1921 to 1926 are as follows:

Year	White	Colored
1921	54.8	90.8
1922	57.1	86.2
1923	54.4	84.7
1924	42.7	103.9
1925	40.3	74.1
1926	36.9	77.1

As in previous years, less progress has been made by the States in getting maternal than infant hygiene work under way, but a significant increase in interest on the part of both medical and lay groups occurred during the past year. Much greater effort will have to be made before the unnecessary deaths among mothers from puerperal septicemia and other puerperal causes shown in the following table are radically reduced:

TABLE 3.—*Mortality from puerperal causes per 10,000 live births; United States birth-registration area, 1921–1925*

Year	Rate per 10,000 live births	Number of live births	Deaths from puerperal causes			
			Total	Puerperal septicemia	Puerperal albuminuria and convulsions	All other
1921	68.2	1,714,261	11,688	4,639	3,081	3,968
1922	66.4	1,774,911	11,792	4,249	3,211	4,332
1923	66.5	1,792,646	11,922	4,495	2,966	4,461
1924	65.6	1,930,614	12,672	4,704	3,441	4,527
1925	64.7	1,878,880	12,158	4,569	3,256	4,333

Reports from the States contain evidence that death rates from puerperal causes among mothers who receive prenatal care are lower than the puerperal rates for communities as a whole. For example, in Louisville, Ky., from 1923 to 1925, 463 infants were born alive to white mothers and 692 to colored mothers who received prenatal care at the Louisville City Hospital. Two of the white mothers and one colored mother died of puerperal causes in the three years. This gives a maternal mortality rate of 43 per 10,000 live births for the white mothers and of 14 per 10,000 for the colored mothers. During the same period the maternal mortality rate for Louisville as a whole was 65 for white mothers and 150 for colored mothers. Neonatal mortality rates also were lower when prenatal care was given. The neonatal rate for white infants whose mothers received prenatal care in the Louisville City Hospital was 23.8 per 1,000 live births as compared with the city rate of 36.5, and the rate for colored

infants whose mothers received prenatal care was 34.7 as compared with the city rate of 48.4.

The really important question in the United States is whether the States will be enabled to do their work long enough to make scientific information as to adequate infant and maternal care available to all parents who desire and need it.

In regard to infant mortality the position of the United States with reference to other countries remained practically the same in 1925 as in 1924. Of the 14 countries for which comparable figures for 1925 are available, 4 (New Zealand, Australia, the Netherlands, and the Irish Free State) had lower rates than the United States, while 9 (Belgium, Chile, England and Wales, Finland, Hungary, Japan, Northern Ireland, Scotland, and Uruguay) had higher rates. In maternal mortality the United States rate was higher than that of any other country for which comparable figures are available.

Extension of the authorized appropriation for maternal and infant hygiene.

Section 2 of the maternity and infancy act authorized an annual appropriation of $1,240,000 for a five-year period to be used by the Children's Bureau in cooperation with the States in promoting the hygiene of maternity and infancy. That five-year period ended with the close of the fiscal year 1927. Believing that this authorized appropriation should be extended, the Secretary of Labor, with the approval of the President, recommended to the chairmen of the House and Senate committees which considered the measure when it was before Congress, that the appropriation in the amount originally authorized should be continued during the fiscal years 1928 and 1929.

The bill introduced by the chairman of the House committee (H. R. 7555) embodying the recommendation made by the Secretary for a two-year extension of the maternity and infancy appropriation was favorably reported by the Committee on Interstate and Foreign Commerce and passed the House April 5, 1926, by a vote of 218 to 44. The House bill was reported to the Senate by the Committee on Education and Labor with an amendment providing that the appropriation should be extended for one year only. The bill did not come to a vote in the Senate until January 13, 1927. While the votes recorded in connection with bringing it to a vote, such as making the bill unfinished business, etc., indicated that more than two-thirds of the Senate favored the House bill, there was very determined opposition on the part of a few Senators, so that defeat by filibuster was threatened. To prevent this the friends of the measure proposed that with the two-year extension of the authorized appropriation the act itself, which was permanent legislation, should be "after June 30, 1929, of no force and effect." With this compromise amendment the House bill was promptly passed by the Senate and concurred in by the House, so that the appropriation has been authorized for the fiscal years 1928 and 1929. Whether or not the cooperation of the Federal Government with the States at the end of this period will continue will be for Congress to decide, as it would have been if the House bill had passed unamended.

The work being done under the act shows that the Federal subsidy has resulted in developing better home care for mothers and babies and better community provision for hospital care at the time of

childbirth. State and local health officials have found that the national interest which national participation in the program creates, as well as the Federal funds made available, has contributed to the success of their work.

CHILD HYGIENE

Community control of rickets—the New Haven study.

The New Haven rickets study completed its third year on September 30, 1926, and as the study was planned as a three-year demonstration, the demonstration clinic was closed at that time. The organization of the data collected has been begun and some progress made. In order to be certain that uniform methods of interpretation were used in reading all the X rays taken throughout the demonstration, a complete review of the plates has been made. The records of physical examinations of the group of children given antirachitic treatment from infancy through 1 to 3 years have been edited, and the material is now ready for statistical analysis.

Study of the X-ray plates in the New Haven rickets study revealed the fact that there were many which were very difficult to interpret because of lack of knowledge as to what could be considered normal. The finding of what were thought to be slight evidences of rickets in the X rays of the bones of many young infants was attributed to the fact that the study was being conducted in a climate where the protective effect of the sunlight, even when reenforced with cod-liver oil, was frequently inadequate entirely to prevent the disease. Some doubt arose, even, as to whether the characteristics noted in these cases were really due to rickets or were simply evidences of normal, rapid growth.

The Porto Rico study.

Before correct interpretation of these plates could be made it seemed important to attempt to establish the normal by study of infants who were receiving adequate antirachitic treatment in a natural manner. In view of the present-day conception of the etiology of rickets it seemed reasonable to suppose that infants born in a tropical country and known to live much of the time out of doors and in houses whose windows were not glazed would show bone growth as nearly normal as it was possible to find. A study was therefore undertaken in Porto Rico to secure a series of X rays of bones of infants living in the Tropics, which might be used in comparison with the series taken in New Haven. With the cooperation of the Department of Health of Porto Rico, the School of Tropical Medicine, the Presbyterian Hospital in San Juan, and the Asilo des Damas in Ponce, examinations were made of approximately 600 Porto Rican infants between the ages of 2 weeks and 2½ years during January and February of 1927. In order that the data obtained in Porto Rico might be as nearly comparable as possible with those obtained in New Haven, the procedures were kept uniform and the work was carried on by the same personnel.

In the group of Porto Rican infants only one case of really active rickets was found, that of an infant 6½ months old who was born and lived for 5½ months in a cellar lighted only by electric light.

No sunlight could enter the room, and the infant was never taken out of doors because he was always considered sick. This infant was admitted to the Presbyterian Hospital for treatment with sunlight alone. After three weeks' exposure of the child without clothes to the tropical sun, definite evidences of healing of the disease were shown by X ray, and at the end of three months the bones had essentially returned to normal. Careful study of the X-ray material gathered in this study in Porto Rico is being made, and the conclusions will be of great value in the further interpretation of the X rays taken in New Haven.

The growth and nutrition of the Porto Rican babies were studied and the presence of physical defects noted. Home investigations of the housing and of the diets of the children and their mothers were made by social investigators. The economic status of the group studied was on the whole low.

The bureau is much indebted to all the individuals and organizations of Porto Rico who cooperated in this study, especially to the physicians and nurses of the department of health, who provided an unfailing supply of babies through their already well-organized child-health clinics.

The posture study in Chelsea, Mass.

Additional tabulations have been made of the material collected during the two-year study of the effect of posture on the physical fitness of children in the schools of Chelsea, Mass., and the report is now being written.

Crippled children.

Field work has been completed in connection with a study of the treatment and education of crippled children in 10 States representing different sections of the country and both rural and densely populated regions. The study has included an examination of laws for the benefit of crippled children and of methods of administration. A description of public provisions for clinic, hospital, and convalescent care and for education and employment service, together with methods of locating cripples and preventive measures being used, will be presented. Accounts of some outstanding private institutions and agencies will also be included in the report.

Popular publications.

The child-hygiene division has continued the preparation of popular bulletins on child health. During the past year the division prepared material to be used in connection with the bureau's exhibit at the Sesquicentennial Exposition. The Baby's Daily Time Cards, Sunlight for Babies, and the posture bulletins have been in great demand. A revised edition of Child Care is in preparation. A third edition of Child Management, with a new section, has been prepared.

CHILD LABOR

Vocational opportunities for minors.

The most important new undertaking of the industrial division of the bureau during the year has been a study of the occupational histories of employed minors in Rochester and Utica, N. Y. This is

one of a series of studies (similar inquiries have been made in Milwaukee and in two New Jersey cities [3]) undertaken with a view to finding out the kinds of occupation open to boys and girls going to work at different ages and with different educational and other qualifications, and the extent to which sex, age, and the amount of general education and special training affect the young workers' opportunity to enter and progress in different occupations, their wages, stability of employment, and other conditions. Information has been obtained for some 4,000 working boys and girls in Rochester, a city of highly diversified industries, and for some 1,000 boys and girls in Utica, a large proportion of whom were employed in textile factories.

Studies of work histories of minors mentally handicapped.

A preliminary analysis has been made of information obtained in connection with a study of work histories of young persons who were formerly inmates of State institutions for the feeble-minded in Illinois, of whom more than four-fifths had intelligence ratings of below 70, the usually accepted borderline of feeble-mindedness. Three-fourths of the boys and girls not only were mentally defective but had had court records for delinquency before they were committed to the institution. It was found that most of the 171 young persons included in the study who had been out of the institution for at least 12 months were gainfully employed and that a considerable number of those who were or had been at work—43 of the 66 boys—had worked at least one-half the time between the date they left the institution and the date they were interviewed.

Most of the boys and girls were in occupations which required little or no industrial or academic training. As was found in a study of 1,000 young persons who had been enrolled in special classes for the mentally defective in the public schools of seven cities [4] but had not been committed to institutions for the feeble-minded, the girls usually either found work as semiskilled operatives in factories or were employed in domestic service. The largest proportion of the boys in this study, as in the former one, had been engaged in occupations classified as manufacturing and mechanical, either as semiskilled operatives or as laborers. The findings of the present as of the former study indicate that boys and girls of less than average mentality can earn their living at certain types of industrial work.

Child labor in New Jersey.

During the past year preliminary analyses of several of the studies of various aspects of the child-labor problem made in 1925–26 have been completed, and the writing of the reports is in progress; the section on children in street trades in Newark and Paterson has been completed and has gone to press. This section is to be published as part of a report on children in street trades in eight cities. The Newark and Paterson study included all children under 16 years of age attending public schools who reported that they had spent at least 26 days in any street work between the close of school in June, 1924, and the date of interview in the spring of 1925. In Newark 1,882 children worked during the school term—467 selling news-

[3] Annual Report of the Secretary of Labor for fiscal year ended June 30, 1926, p. 74. Washington, 1926.
[4] Work Opportunities for Young Persons of Subnormal Mentality (report in preparation).

papers, 679 carrying newspapers, and 736 bootblacking, peddling, and doing other street work. During vacation 1,633 had worked—450 selling newspapers, 407 carrying newspapers, and 776 bootblacking, peddling, and doing other street work. In Paterson, of the 413 children working during the school term 108 sold newspapers, 178 carried newspapers, and 127 peddled or did other street work; of the 425 vacation workers 118 sold newspapers, 145 carried newspapers, and 162 peddled or did other street work. Facts were obtained concerning the age and grade attainment of the children, the nature of the work in the various street trades and its probable effect upon the children, and the extent and effectiveness of legal regulations.

Laws affecting the employment of minors, and their administration.

A revision to date of the texts of the child-labor and compulsory school attendance laws of the various States published by the bureau in 1915 is nearing completion.

Work has been started in connection with an inquiry into the provisions and the methods of administration of the State workmen's compensation laws as they affect employed minors. It is planned in this inquiry to study the methods of reporting accidents and of awarding compensation to child workers.

Current statistics of children to whom first regular employment certificates were issued.

The industrial division of the bureau has continued to receive from State and city officials current reports of employment certificates issued. Information has been compiled for 10 States and the District of Columbia and for 24 cities of 50,000 population or over outside these States relative to the numbers of children receiving first regular employment certificates or work permits in the calendar year 1926.

The records of work permits issued to children between 14 and 16 years of age in the places reporting to the bureau, although they do not include the large number entering occupations for which certificates are not required under the State laws, nor those going to work illegally, are representative of conditions in most of the important child-employing centers, as regards at least the legal employment of children of work-permit age in most industrial and commercial pursuits. But the number of first regular certificates issued does not indicate the total number of children at work at any given time but only the number beginning work during a single year.

In 1926, 107,257 children of 14 and 15 years of age received first regular certificates in the 10 States which sent in complete reports, in the 24 cities reporting outside these States, and in the District of Columbia. Of the total number of first regular certificates issued, 18,429 were in places where regular certificates are issued for vacation and after-school work as well as for full-time employment and no separate record is made. The accompanying table gives the number of first regular employment certificates issued in the States and the cities for which reports were obtained in 1926 and also such corresponding information as was reported in 1925.

TABLE 4.—*Number of children 14 and 15 years of age receiving regular employment certificates for the first time, 1925 and 1926, and per cent of increase or decrease as compared with the previous year, in States and cities reporting* [1]

State and city [2]	1925	Per cent of increase (+) or decrease (−) as compared with 1924 [3]	1926	Per cent of increase (+) or decrease (−) as compared with 1925 [3]
States reporting:				
Alabama	1,005	+10.3	960	−4.5
Birmingham	179	+20.1	240	+34.1
Mobile	60	−21.1	89	+48.3
Connecticut	7,605	+26.9	7,574	−.4
Bridgeport	785	+29.8	878	+11.8
Hartford	676	+18.2	645	−4.6
New Britain	478	+37.4	391	−18.2
New Haven	927	+14.4	1,057	+14.0
Waterbury	634	+17.4	571	−9.9
District of Columbia	134	−67.5	220	+64.2
Indiana	966	−12.9	1,103	+14.2
Indianapolis	255	−10.8	346	+35.7
Evansville	2		5	
Fort Wayne	56	−9.7	58	+3.6
South Bend	98	−6.7	88	−10.2
Kansas	70	−25.5	121	+72.9
Kansas City	47	−9.6	75	
Topeka	6		23	
Wichita	8		8	
Kentucky	889	+5.7	969	+9.0
Covington	76	−7.3	56	−26.3
Louisville	547	−14.5	638	+16.6
Maine	[4] 272		[4] 256	−5.9
Portland	[4] 24		[4] 21	
Maryland	[5] 4,132	+9.7	[5] 4,449	+7.7
Baltimore	[5] 3,948	+12.0	[5] 4,229	+7.1
Minnesota			404	
Duluth			11	
Minneapolis [5a]	196	+18.8	171	−12.8
St. Paul [5a]	180	−2.7	160	−11.1
New Jersey	[6] 17,820	+7.2	[6] 18,429	+3.4
Jersey City [5a]	[6] 1,599	+1.6	[6] 1,638	+2.4
Newark [5a]	[6] 2,237	+2.0	[6] 2,494	+11.5
Passaic [5a]	[6] 595		[6] 549	−7.7
Trenton [5a]	[6] 920	+17.3	[6] 906	−1.5
Vermont	91		96	+5.5
Cities in States not reporting:				
Atlanta, Ga			132	
Buffalo, N. Y			[7] 2,654	
Chicago, Ill	4,962	−8.8	5,149	+3.8
Detroit, Mich	[4] 410	+13.6	[4] 635	+54.9
Grand Rapids, Mich			[4] 267	
Harrisburg, Pa	152	+43.4	154	+1.3
Lincoln, Nebr	10		5	
Los Angeles, Calif			744	
Milwaukee, Wis	2,481	+28.8	2,047	−17.5
New Orleans, La	[8] 2,506	+9.5	[8] 2,563	+2.3
New York, N. Y	32,814	+2.0	35,484	+8.1
Niagara Falls, N. Y	178		252	+41.6
Omaha, Nebr	161		136	−15.5
Philadelphia, Pa	10,349	+24.9	11,194	+8.2
Pittsburgh, Pa	2,028	+8.8	1,945	−4.1
Providence, R. I			[4] 1,633	
Rochester, N. Y	1,833	+16.0	1,841	+.4
St. Louis, Mo	3,528	+4.8	3,407	−3.4
Salt Lake City, Utah			222	
San Francisco, Calif	267	+9.9	163	−39.0
Scranton, Pa	949		845	−11.0
Syracuse, N. Y	447		427	−4.5
Wilmington, Del			252	
Yonkers, N. Y	384	+35.2	525	+36.7

[1] Compiled, except where otherwise noted, from figures furnished by certificating officers, school officials, labor officials, or others charged with responsibility for certificate issuance.

[2] Includes States, and cities of 50,000 population and over according to the census of 1920, for which figures for 1926 were available.

[3] Per cent of increase or decrease not shown for total States and cities as comparable figures are not available for the 3 years for all States and cities; not shown where base is less than 50.

[4] Number of 15-year-old children receiving certificates; law does not permit the issuance of regular certificates to children under 15.

[5] Annual Report of the Commissioner of Labor and Statistics of Maryland, 1925, pp. 23, 40; 1926, pp. 13, 24.

[5a] Information furnished by city officials.

[6] Includes children to whom certificates were issued for work outside school hours, no separate certificates for such work being provided by law.

[7] Number reported for year ended Nov. 30.

[8] Report of the Factories' Inspection Department of the Parish of Orleans, 1925, p. 4; 1926, p. 5.

Information concerning the number of children 14 and 15 years of age receiving first regular certificates is available for each of the three years—1924, 1925, and 1926—for 7 States for which complete reports were obtained, for 14 cities in 9 other States, and for the District of Columbia. Five of the 7 States, the District of Columbia, and 8 of the 14 cities outside these States reported increases in 1926 over the previous year in the number of children 14 and 15 years of age entering employment for the first time. The total number of children to whom first certificates were issued (in all the States and cities for which comparable information was obtained for the three years) increased 5 per cent in 1926 as compared with 1925, whereas the increase for 1925 as compared with 1924 was 8 per cent.

Valuable as are these reports of the number of work permits issued, it must be remembered that a variation from one year to the next in the number of children receiving first certificates in any particular locality may be due not to actual increases or decreases in the total number of working children but to other factors. More children, for example, may receive certificates because the application of the child labor law has been extended to occupations not previously covered or because the administration of the law has been improved. Also, actual increases or decreases in the total number of working children may be due to other causes than changes in the child labor law or in its enforcement—particularly to the fluctuations of business and industrial conditions.

All the States for which figures either for cities or for the State as a whole are given in the preceding table require a child to be at least 14 years of age before a regular employment certificate may be issued allowing him to leave school for work; of these, four (California,[5] Michigan, Maine, and Rhode Island) place the minimum age at 15. In all these States except Georgia, where the law applies only to factories and workshops, certificates are required for work in factories, stores, and usually other places of employment. Three of these States (Indiana, Minnesota, and Vermont) require all children 14 and 15 years of age going to work regularly to have completed the eighth grade, three States (Delaware, Nebraska, and Rhode Island[6]) and the District of Columbia have this standard with exceptions, and two (New York and California) require the completion of the eighth grade for all 14-year-old children to whom regular certificates are granted.[6a] These legal standards of age and schooling obviously affect the age at which children leave school for work, though this is affected also by many other factors, such as the demand for children in the local industries, family tradition and economic status, and local industrial conditions.

The age at which children receive first regular certificates was reported by 8 States, by 21 cities in other States, and by the District of Columbia. Nearly two-fifths (38 per cent) of the 90,046 children whose ages were reported went to work for the first time when they were 14 years of age. The influence of a high grade requirement is

[5] The California law allows children to go to work regularly at 14 only if they have completed the eighth grade and their earnings are necessary for family support; with this exception the minimum age is 15.

[6] After July 1, 1926.

[6a] Of the other States included in the table, Kansas, Utah, and Wisconsin also require completion of the eighth grade, with or without exemptions, but figures as to grade attained by children receiving first regular certificates were not received for these three States.

reflected in the fact that the proportion of children going to work at 14 years of age was more than twice as large in places where there was no eighth-grade requirement as it was in places where this restriction was in effect. Of the 42,949 children to whom certificates were issued in 4 States and 7 cities where the educational requirement was less than graduation from the eighth grade, 56 per cent obtained first regular certificates at the age of 14, as compared with 24 per cent of 42,786 children in 3 States and 6 cities where graduation from the eighth grade was required without exceptions.

The majority (59 per cent) of 87,983 children to whom first certificates were issued (including a slightly larger proportion of girls than of boys) and for whom a report as to grade last attained was made, had either attended or had completed the eighth or a higher grade; one-fifth (20 per cent) had attended or completed the seventh grade; and the remainder (21 per cent) had gone no further in school than the sixth grade, including a very small percentage (one-half of 1 per cent) who had not reached even the fifth grade.

In the following States and cities less than 60 per cent of the children 14 and 15 years of age going to work had reached the eighth or a higher grade:

	Per cent		Per cent
Alabama	22	Buffalo, N. Y	59
Connecticut	58	Niagara Falls, N. Y	57
Kentucky	32	Rochester, N. Y	58
New Orleans, La	32	Syracuse, N. Y	55
Maine	49	Harrisburg, Pa	31
Baltimore, Md	30	Philadelphia, Pa	54
Newark, N. J	44	Pittsburgh, Pa	40
Passaic, N. J	36	Scranton, Pa	33
Trenton, N. J	39	Providence, R. I	57

The educational attainment of the children is affected of course by the educational requirements set up by the States. Most of the States from which information as to schooling was received, moreover, are States having a sixth-grade or a higher educational requirement, and with one exception (Louisiana) no reports were received from States with no educational requirement. In Indiana and Minnesota, in which the eighth-grade standard was in effect for children of both 14 and 15 years of age and from which both grade and age reports were obtained, practically 100 per cent of the children had actually completed the eighth grade. In San Francisco, Calif., and in New York City, Niagara Falls, Rochester, Syracuse, and Yonkers, N. Y.—States which had the eighth-grade requirement for 14-year-old children only and a lower requirement for 15-year-old children—67 per cent of 38,692 children receiving first certificates (including practically all those aged 14 and more than one-half of those aged 15) had attended or completed the eighth grade. Reports on certificates issued in 4 States and 13 cities having less than an eighth-grade requirement for both 14 and 15 year old children showed that 49 per cent of the children receiving certificates had completed or last attended the eighth or a higher grade, and that 22 per cent had not advanced further than the sixth (or a lower) grade.

The occupations of 34,034 children who received first regular certificates were reported by 8 States, 16 cities in other States,[7] and the District of Columbia. The predominance of different industries in the different communities and the varying provisions of State child-labor laws requiring employment certificates for certain kinds of work or prohibiting certain occupations to children under 16 affect the distribution in the various industries of children to whom certificates are issued. Forty-six per cent of these children entered manufacturing or mechanical industries, 30 per cent went into mercantile establishments, and 25 per cent into "other" employment, which includes a large number entering messenger and errand work. More than 50 per cent of the children to whom certificates were issued in each of four States and five cities entered manufacturing or mechanical work; in two cities more than 50 per cent entered mercantile establishments; and in one State, six cities, and the District of Columbia more than 50 per cent entered "other" employment.

One of the most important administrative features of the certificate law is the proof of age required of children applying for employment certificates. The best laws usually specify the order in which different kinds of evidence are required. An official birth certificate is commonly placed first, baptismal record second, and parent's affidavit or signed statement last if it is sanctioned at all. The kinds of proof actually accepted for first regular certificates were reported for 48,870 certificates, issued in 7 States, 22 cities, and the District of Columbia. The proportion of children presenting as evidence birth certificates or baptismal records was 90 per cent or more in 2 States and 10 cities; from 75 to 90 per cent in 3 States and 4 cities and the District of Columbia; and less than 75 per cent in the remaining States and cities from which reports were received. In 1 State and 2 cities the proportion of birth and baptismal certificates presented as evidence was between 1 and 10 per cent and in 3 other cities there was no case where evidence of this type was presented.

The employment-certificate provisions are extended in New York and Wisconsin to minors aged 16 and in Michigan to minors aged 16 and 17. In Ohio regular employment certificates are issued only to minors 16 and 17 years of age.[8] Ohio requires completion of the seventh grade for the issuance of certificates to minors of this age, but exceptions to this requirement are permitted under certain conditions of mental defect and of family need. In the other States the grade requirement is waived after the sixteenth birthday is reached. The number of minors 16 and 17 years of age to whom first regular employment certificates were issued in 1926 in the cities in these States submitting reports was as follows:

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[7] Omitting figures for Atlanta, where certificates are issued only for work in factories and workshops.

[8] A certificate allowing a mentally subnormal child between 14 and 16 years of age to leave school for work may be issued under certain specified conditions.

TABLE 5.—*Minors 16 and 17 years of age to whom first regular employment certificates were issued in 1926; cities reporting in specified States*

City	Minors 16 and 17 years of age			City	Minors 16 and 17 years of age		
	Total	Aged 16	Aged 17		Total	Aged 16	Aged 17
Michigan:				New York—Continued			
Detroit	7,962	(1)	(1)	Yonkers	409	409	----
Grand Rapids	917	742	175	Ohio:			
New York:				Columbus	789	374	415
Buffalo	3,094	3,094	----	Dayton	700	(1)	(1)
New York	12,666	12,666	----	Toledo	1,398	(1)	(1)
Rochester	1,247	1,247	----	Youngstown	843	603	240
Syracuse	248	248	----	Wisconsin: Milwaukee	1,948	1,948	----

[1] Not reported by age.

During the year a revised and improved report blank has been prepared for the use of State and city officials furnishing employment-certificate statistics to the bureau. This blank is being tried out in mimeographed form by a number of officials in making up their reports for 1926 and 1927. A representative of the bureau is visiting State departments charged with the supervision of certificate issuance or the enforcement of child-labor laws and also certificate-issuing offices in most of the larger cities throughout the country for the purpose of explaining the new form.

DELINQUENCY AND CHILD WELFARE

The Chicago boys' court.

Accurate information is not available concerning the prevalence of crime among young people, the characteristics and histories of young offenders above juvenile-court age, the methods of dealing with them, and the results obtained. In order to throw some light on this subject the Children's Bureau undertook a study of the cases heard by the boys' court branch of the Chicago Municipal Court, which is the only specialized court in the United States dealing exclusively with young people between juvenile-court age and the age of legal majority.

The number of boys' court cases per 10,000 population in Chicago of the ages dealt with by the boys' court was lower in 1925 than in any other of the 11 years included in the study with the exception of 1923, and was highest in 1915. In contrast with this record in the boys' court the case rate was higher for 1925 than for previous years in the municipal court as a whole.

The Children's Bureau studied intensively 972 cases disposed of by the boys' court in 1924 and 1925. The records showed that 42.1 per cent of the boys in this group had been previously arrested after they had passed the age of juvenile-court jurisdiction and that 24.6 per cent had delinquency records in the juvenile court. Forty-seven per cent had neither previous juvenile-court nor other court records, so far as was known, 11 per cent had juvenile-court records only, and 27.9 per cent had other court records only.

For the boys with juvenile-court records information was obtained concerning the disposition of the last case in the juvenile court.

Nearly half (48.4 per cent) had been committed to an institution, 20.7 per cent had been placed on probation, and the cases of 26.7 per cent had been dismissed, dropped, or continued generally. This is a large proportion with experience in institutions for juvenile delinquents. Institutional commitments formed only 27.8 per cent of all Cook County juvenile-court commitments during the eight years previous to 1924.

Institutional treatment of juvenile delinquency.

Since institutional care is frequently a last resort, the care and training of juvenile delinquents in institutions presents many problems. A section of the bureau's study of child welfare in New Jersey relating to this subject is still in preparation. The responsibility for the care of juvenile delinquents committed to the State schools is divided by the New Jersey Department of Institutions and Agencies among the classification service, the institutions, and the parole service. The bureau report will include general material on the standards of care of juvenile delinquents in institutions, as well as description and analysis of the care given in New Jersey.

Alcoholism among parents of juvenile delinquents.

Accurate information as to the social effects of prohibition is for several reasons not available. The collection of such information presents great difficulties. The period of time is too brief for general conclusions, and in the absence of comparable data over a period of time determining which of several factors is responsible for social changes becomes practically impossible. Because data were available in Boston for comparisons between present and preprohibition conditions the bureau undertook a study there with a view to determining what is the incidence of alcoholism among the parents of delinquent children and whether this complicating factor in juvenile delinquency is an increasing or a decreasing problem. The group chosen for study consisted of 2,378 delinquent children referred by the Central Boston Juvenile Court to the Judge Baker Foundation clinic during the eight-year period from July 1, 1917, to June 30, 1925. This group was selected for study because the records of the foundation afforded comprehensive information about the family life of the children coming to the clinic. Furthermore, the children examined in the clinic represented those who had come to the courts because their behavior presented some serious problem.

The records of these children showed that 41 per cent of the fathers and 7 per cent of the mothers were reported to be alcoholic. Although the information obtained showed no relation between the type of offense for which a child was brought to the court and intemperance on the part of the parents, alcoholism of the parents was associated with the number of times a child appeared in court. Repeaters—that is, children who were brought into court more than once—were more likely than first offenders to come from homes in which alcoholism was a problem.

Since alcoholism of the parents is an added complication in the treatment of juvenile delinquency, in that it seriously affects the cooperation to be expected of the parents in the treatment that the court decides is necessary to correct those habits held responsible for the child's delinquency, it is important to discover whether or

not it is an increasing or a decreasing problem. Investigation of this phase of the subject took two forms—a study of the persistence of alcoholism among fathers whose past records could be compared with their present habits, and the analysis of the proportionate number of the children referred to the clinic in each year from 1917 to 1925 whose fathers had been alcoholic. The results of this inquiry show that 29 per cent of the men studied who were alcoholic in 1918–19 were not alcoholic in 1924–25. Evidence of a decrease in alcoholism is shown also by the change in the rate of alcoholism among the fathers in different years. The highest rate (41 per cent) was for the year ended June 30, 1919; the lowest (16 per cent) was for 1921–22. The rate in 1924–25 (23 per cent) was somewhat higher than for 1921–22 but definitely lower than that for the preprohibition period.

Uniform reporting of juvenile-court statistics.

During the year the plan for uniform reporting of juvenile-court statistics of delinquency, dependency, and neglect has been put into operation. The proposed report forms have been presented to juvenile courts and State departments of public welfare through correspondence with judges and probation officers and personal visits to many of the courts.

Judges, probation officers, and representatives of State departments of public welfare have responded with a great deal of interest. Already about 80 courts in 20 States have promised cooperation and have been supplied with statistical cards. These courts represent different parts of the country; for instance, California, Washington, Georgia, Indiana, Massachusetts, and Minnesota, to mention only a few States. The number of cases dealt with by the cooperating courts varies from less than 50 a year to several thousands. Among the large cities cooperating in the plan are New York, Philadelphia, Buffalo, Detroit, Cincinnati, Minneapolis, St. Paul, Los Angeles, San Francisco, Pittsburgh, and Washington.

The assistance given by State boards or departments of public welfare, especially in States which are developing a system of uniform reports, has been especially encouraging. Twenty-six departments have promised cooperation varying in degree. Some have assumed responsibility for introducing the plan and trying it out in selected courts, some have revised their own report forms in line with the uniform classification, and others, unable to cooperate to such an extent, are distributing bulletins and calling the plan to the attention of court workers as opportunities arise.

Cards are being received monthly or quarterly from a number of cooperating courts, and the work of tabulation is being done currently so that tables may be completed promptly at the close of the year. A representative of the bureau keeps in touch with courts using the plan, assisting them by means of correspondence or visits if they experience any difficulty in using the statistical cards.

STUDIES OF DEPENDENT CHILDREN

Histories of children of illegitimate birth.

Earlier studies by the bureau have treated of various aspects of illegitimacy as a community problem. The purpose of this study was to interpret the results of the experience of a number of agencies in

following the plan of keeping the children of illegitimate birth with their mothers. Case records were obtained from 27 organizations located in 11 cities, whose policies were to assist the mother or relatives in assuming the responsibility for the child and in helping the mother to make a normal readjustment in the community. Histories of 253 children were obtained, and with few exceptions these showed that the children had been successfully absorbed into the life of the communities.

More than half the mothers desired to keep their babies from the first, but some of the mothers needed persuasion by the agencies. Paternal responsibility was assumed voluntarily or fixed as a result of court action in about one-third of the cases. The amounts the fathers were ordered to pay were far from adequate to provide for the children, and only about one-half of the men ordered to support their children were known to have met their obligations satisfactorily. The men who entered into private agreements showed a greater sense of responsibility. The mothers of one-half of the children had married, about one-fifth of them having married the fathers of the children. Some of the mothers were working and keeping the children with them in their places of employment. The other children were in the homes of relatives or in boarding homes.

An analysis of the histories shows a favorable outlook for the future for a majority of the children, as a result of the care and supervision the agencies had given. As a rule the children were not known as illegitimate in the communities in which they lived. In the few cases in which the children's status was known they were being kindly treated and apparently had suffered no ostracism.

Handbook for the use of boards of directors, superintendents, and staffs of institutions for dependent children.

The preparation of this handbook was suggested by the Georgia State Department of Public Welfare. A preliminary draft prepared by the Georgia department was revised and enlarged by the Children's Bureau with the assistance of an advisory committee composed of representatives of State boards and of public and private institutions and other experts in this field, and was issued early in 1927. It outlines standards of care for children of different ages in institutions and discusses policies, management, equipment, and plans of institutions for dependent children. Its reception indicates that it fulfills a long-felt want of institutional administrators and board members who are eager to make the institution for which they are responsible measure up to the highest standard of service for children.

STATE AND COUNTY CHILD-WELFARE ACTIVITIES

Child-welfare conditions and resources in seven Pennsylvania counties.

The report of a study of child-welfare conditions and resources in a group of seven Pennsylvania counties, made in cooperation with the Pennsylvania Children's Commission, has been completed and published. This study was made in order to determine the proportion of the children in the community in whose behalf community care or supervision in one form or another has been undertaken and the extent to which the measures undertaken have succeeded in securing for the children the conditions required for their welfare.

The survey of these seven counties showed that 1,326 children under 18 years of age came to the attention of courts or correctional institutions during the year covered by the study. Throughout the counties six types of courts heard and disposed of these cases. Legally all child offenders under 16 can be taken to the juvenile court, but the survey revealed that almost one-half of these children were being taken before other courts.

In the seven counties 8,145 children (2.9 per cent of the estimated population under 18 years of age) had received some form of organized social assistance in the course of a year. One-fifth had received care away from their families, and four-fifths had received assistance in their own homes (from overseers of the poor, mothers' assistance boards, or private family-welfare agencies). The children cared for away from their homes were in the custody of 69 organizations (institutions or agencies) caring for dependent children. The multiplicity of organizations and agencies assuming the responsibility of caring for children increases the importance of unification of purpose, coordination of effort, and State supervision of these agencies as insurance against abuses.

From a review of the numbers of agencies and the methods employed the conclusion seems inevitable that the solution of the problems of child care in Pennsylvania lies not in the creation of additional agencies or institutions, public or private, but in the more intelligent and discriminating use of those in existence and in the insistence that all who engage in this work must meet at least minimum standards of service and responsibility.

Child welfare in Washington.

At the request of the Washington State Conference of Social Agencies a study is now being made of the care that is being given to dependent, defective, and delinquent children in six representative counties of the State. The counties studied include some that are almost entirely rural and others that contain a large city with many social resources. This study in common with the somewhat similar studies made in North Dakota, South Dakota, Georgia, and Pennsylvania will provide accurate information about the extent of dependency, defect, and delinquency, and about the facilities and work of public and private agencies providing care for children in the countries studied.

Conclusions will be based on a study of the individual records of all children in the counties brought before the courts or in care of agencies during the year preceding March 1, 1927, and of all families with children who received relief or assistance during the same period. The field work also includes gathering data as to the health and recreation resources of the communities and information on the organization and activities of all available social agencies and institutions.

RECREATION

A bulletin on recreation for blind children was published during the year. This report suggests recreational activities such as club work, music, and dramatics, describes games and competitions of various sorts, and includes a number of sections on programs and

events that have been found practical by members of school staffs and other individuals working with the blind.

The preparation of a report on the methods of supervision and control of commercial and community recreation has been completed, and the report will be published early in 1928. It includes a digest of the dance-hall ordinances of about 500 cities of 15,000 population or over and a survey of 17 cities having different types of dance-hall control and community recreation programs.

The bureau has cooperated with the State agricultural extension service in providing recreation courses in the State camps to the members and leaders of the Four-H clubs of West Virginia and Vermont. The programs used were planned to give these farm boys and girls games that would be especially useful during recess periods in rural schools, at club meetings, and at parties, and to help them gain experience in leading such activities.

Upon the request of the Woman's Club of Omar, W. Va., a four months' playground program was planned, and play leaders were given a short training course for 12 playgrounds in the mining camps near that town. The playgrounds that had been badly equipped and unsupervised for several years before were replanned to allow space for games, and a program was worked out with the play leaders by the bureau's specialist in recreation.

STATE CHILD-WELFARE COMMISSIONS

During the past year child-welfare commissions have been active in Georgia, Pennsylvania, and South Dakota. A bill to continue the Delaware Children's Laws Commission, created in 1923, and to appropriate $5,000 to enable it to complete its work was not passed. In Washington a bill for a children's code commission failed to become a law. California created a commission for the study of problem children, to consist of seven members appointed by the governor. The commission, in conjunction with the board of juvenile research of Whittier State School, is directed to make a study of juvenile delinquency and to report and recommend to the legislature a plan for the prevention of juvenile delinquency and the proper care and training of predelinquent, delinquent, psychopathic, and maladjusted children.

The Georgia Children's Code Commission has been at work for some years, studying the child-welfare needs of the State, working out proposals for improving children's laws, and educating the public to the needs of Georgia's children. Five bills, dealing with juvenile courts, mothers' aid, adoption, nonsupport and desertion, and illegitimacy, were presented to the 1927 session of the legislature, which convened on June 22. The illegitimacy bill and the nonsupport and desertion bill were based upon the uniform acts drafted by the National Conference of Commissioners on Uniform State Laws. Jurisdiction under both these bills would be vested in the juvenile court except when trial by jury is demanded, when the case would be transferred to the superior court. The standard juvenile-court act drafted by a committee of the National Probation Association was taken as the basis of the proposed juvenile-court act, changes being made to suit Georgia conditions.

Georgia is one of six States without any provision for public aid to dependent children in their own homes. The mothers' aid bill provided for assistance to be administered by the juvenile-court advisory board of each county and to be available for children under the age of 16 years whose parents, guardians, or other persons having legal custody are unable without such assistance to provide for their proper care in their own homes.

In addition to the support of the Georgia Children's Code Commission, all these bills were sponsored by 10 organizations making up the Legislative Council of Women. They were passed by the senate and favorably reported by the house committee, but with the exception of the adoption measure they failed of enactment owing to a filibuster in the house.

The adoption bill was amended considerably before passage; provisions relating to investigation, annulment, and concurrent juvenile-court jurisdiction were omitted. The new law provides for notice to and consent of a child-placing agency if the child is in custody thereof, for a six months' trial period, final adoption to be granted only on a second hearing, and for filing of a copy of the decree of adoption with the State registrar of vital statistics.

The Pennsylvania Children's Commission gathered information regarding the cases of dependent children in the juvenile courts of Philadelphia and Allegheny Counties and regarding cases of child offenders in the Pittsburgh Morals Court. It prepared, published, and circulated a pamphlet setting forth "The Legal Foundations of the Jurisdiction, Powers, Organization, and Procedure of the Courts of Pennsylvania in Their Handling of Cases of Juvenile Offenders and of Dependent and Neglected Children." In its report to the 1927 general assembly the commission reviewed the operation of the two laws sponsored by it and passed in 1925, relating to adoptions and infant boarding homes and recommended a slight amendment to the adoption act. Five new measures were recommended: (1) An act repealing the indenture laws; (2) an act for the further control of child placement; (3) a measure to prohibit the placement of children for hire, gain, or reward; (4) an act providing for the licensing of maternity homes or hospitals; and (5) an act to amend the juvenile court act, confining the jurisdiction of the courts to delinquent, wayward, and neglected children, and making certain other changes. The first bill repealing the indenture laws was passed, but the other four failed. The commission, which was created in 1923, was not continued by the legislature.

The South Dakota Child Welfare Commission, which has been carrying on both legislative and administrative activities, was continued with an appropriation of $3,000 for the ensuing biennium. A bill to amend the law creating the commission, giving it increased administrative duties, and a bill making it the duty of the commission to regulate child placing and to license, visit, supervise, and regulate every agency, public, semipublic, or private, which engages in the business for gain or otherwise of receiving and caring for children or placing or boarding them in private homes, failed to pass. The rules of both houses were amended to provide for a joint standing committee on child welfare—a measure believed by the commission to be an important forward step. A determined effort to repeal the mothers' pension law was defeated, in part as the result

of a report of a state-wide survey of mothers' pensions presented by the commission. A law was enacted providing for investigations in adoption cases by a probation officer, an agent of the State child-welfare commission or county child-welfare board, or other competent person, and for a trial period of six months before adoption. Another measure sponsored by the commission which became a law amended the law relating to incorporated child-caring associations by providing that children should not be placed in family homes temporarily or permanently, for adoption or otherwise, unless such children are surrendered to the association by order or decree of a county or circuit court.

The South Dakota commission has continued its county-organization work and called the first annual conference of county welfare boards with the State commission, attended by 65 county welfare board members. Assistance was given in a survey of the feeble-minded, and educational work was carried on.

The 1925 law creating a Porto Rican Child Welfare Board was amended to provide that in addition to the study of problems affecting childhood and the revision of child-welfare legislation, the board shall inspect all children's institutions, public or private, and investigate all asylums, charity schools, and reform schools caring for children under the age of 18 years. A four-year term of office for board members is provided, two of whom shall be women.

STATE CHILD-WELFARE LEGISLATION, 1927 [9]

The legislatures of 44 States have met in regular session during 1927, and 2 (Virginia and Louisiana) which did not have a regular session met in special session, leaving only 2 (Kentucky and Mississippi) which did not meet this year. The Legislatures of Alaska, Hawaii, and Porto Rico also had regular sessions. Legislative material has been received in the Children's Bureau from practically all these States, and information concerning child-welfare measures has been published in a number of issues of the Child Welfare News Summary.

Child labor [10] and compulsory school attendance.

Measures relating to child labor were proposed in a large number of the States. Bills making significant improvements in standards for the employment of children, however, are known to have been passed in only five States—Illinois, Maine, Maryland, Michigan, and North Carolina. Less important changes were made in three States—Connecticut, Nevada, and West Virginia. Connecticut passed two laws, one making provision for a part-time certificate which permits the employment of children outside school hours without complying with the educational requirements for regular employment (formerly such a certificate could be issued only for work during the school vacation), and the other forbidding the employment of children under 16 after 10 p. m. on the nights when they are permitted by law to work after 6 p. m.; that is, one night a week

[9] Information relating to Georgia bills on juvenile courts, mothers' aid, nonsupport, desertion, and illegitimacy is given under State child-welfare commissions, pp. 23–24.

[10] Action on the pending child-labor amendment to the Federal Constitution is given on p. 27.

throughout the year and the nights from December 17 to Christmas. Nevada passed a law prohibiting the employment of children under 18 in public dance halls. West Virginia amended its child labor law so as to require the written consent of the parent or custodian of the child before any work permit can be issued. Measures which to some extent would raise standards for maximum hours of work of girls 16 years of age and over were passed in Arizona (extending the application of the 8-hour law for females and reducing the weekly hours from 56 to 48) and in New York (fixing a 48-hour week for women, with exemptions.)

Three of the States improving their child-labor standards (Michigan, Illinois, and Maryland) did so through amendments to their workmen's compensation laws, which provide for the payment of additional compensation in the case of minors injured while illegally employed. In Michigan (in the case of minors between 16 and 18) and Maryland (in the case of all minors) the amount required to be paid in case of injury is double that otherwise awarded; in Illinois 50 per cent additional compensation must be paid if the person injured is a minor under 16 employed contrary to law. Previously in each of these three States illegally employed minors if injured were deprived of the benefits of the compensation laws. In addition to these three States, Missouri approved by referendum vote in November, 1926, a workmen's compensation law enacted by the legislature in 1925, which requires 50 per cent additional compensation in case of minors injured while illegally employed.

Maine raised the educational requirement for children under 16 leaving school for work from completion of the sixth to completion of the eighth grade, with a proviso permitting the issuance of special work permits to children unable to reach this standard because of subnormal mentality. Bowling alleys and pool rooms were added to the places of employment prohibited to minors under 14 years of age outside school hours (the minimum age during school hours is 15); a minimum age of 16 was fixed for the employment of children as ushers in theaters and motion-picture houses, or as elevator operators in hotels, lodging houses, or apartment houses; the minimum age for operating rapidly moving elevators, however, was reduced from 18 to 16.

North Carolina passed a law which, as interpreted by the State attorney general, provides a maximum 8-hour day and 48-hour week for the employment of children 14 and 15 years of age who have not completed the fourth grade. For children of these ages who have completed the fourth grade the maximum 11-hour day and 60-hour week for minors under 21 years of age in factories and manufacturing establishments is still applicable, and there are no restrictions (other than the night-work prohibition) on their hours of labor in stores and other establishments. The new law also makes the prohibited night-work period for children under 16 begin at 7 p. m. instead of 9 p. m.

Reports have been received of a number of attempted advances in the standards of State child-labor and compulsory school attendance laws which failed of enactment, but information with regard to these bills is incomplete. In Nevada, Missouri, and Wyoming bills raising general child-labor standards and eliminating serious weaknesses in the present laws failed to pass.

Efforts to shorten the hours of labor for children failed in Connecticut (which has a 58-hour week for children in stores); in New Hampshire (which has a 10¼-hour day and a 54-hour week); in North Carolina (a bill was passed, however, reducing hours of labor for children who have not completed the fourth grade); and in Rhode Island (which has a 10-hour day and a 54-hour week).

Bills to raise the educational requirement for children going to work failed in Connecticut and Illinois, which now have a sixth-grade standard; in New Jersey, with a fifth-grade standard; and in Maryland, with a fifth-grade standard in Baltimore City and a seventh-grade standard elsewhere. A bill to restrict the employment of children under 14 on the stage failed in California. In Maryland bills to prohibit children under 16 from operating steam or electric machinery and to extend the night-work prohibition for children under 16 failed. In Massachusetts a bill to extend the period of compulsory school attendance failed. In North Carolina a bill extending the age for compulsory school attendance from 14 to 16 (except for children who have completed the fourth grade) was defeated. In Rhode Island bills prohibiting the employment of children under 16 between 7 p. m. and 6 a. m. instead of between 8 p. m. and 6 a. m. and extending the application of the street trades law failed to pass. In Nebraska, South Carolina, and Wisconsin bills increasing the number of months per year during which children must attend school throughout the State or in certain localities failed to pass.

Attempts to raise standards of maximum hours of work or to strengthen the night-work prohibitions for females, which would have affected the work of minor girls, failed in California, Connecticut, Florida, Illinois, Minnesota, Nevada, Nebraska, New Jersey, North Carolina, and West Virginia.

An attempt to cope with the problem of the schooling of migratory child workers by legislative methods was made by the introduction in the New Jersey and Pennsylvania Legislatures of bills making it unlawful for nonresident children to be employed during the time when the laws of the State of the child's residence require his attendance in school. These bills were proposed as a result of several conferences between the school and the labor authorities of Pennsylvania and New Jersey and certain welfare interests of the two States; and it was hoped that after these States had taken the lead, similar legislation would be passed in the neighboring States. Neither bill became law, however. The New Jersey bill passed one house but did not come to a vote in the other. The Pennsylvania bill was passed by both houses but was vetoed by the governor because its title was defective.

A backward step was taken in Minnesota, where the law providing that permits for employment in theatrical exhibitions should not be issued to children under 10 years of age was amended to allow the industrial commission to use its discretion in permitting such employment for children under 10. Minnesota also eliminated the provision in the dangerous-occupation section of its child labor law which prohibited children under 16 from working in establishments manufacturing paints, colors, or white lead, and exempted canneries for 75 days per year from the hours of labor law for females, thus increasing the possible legal hours of work of minor girls. In Michigan the exemption to the hours of labor law for women and

minors was extended to include shipping perishable goods in fruit or vegetable canning establishments, exempted work, however, to be approved by the State department of labor as not injurious to health.

Some reports have been received of bills attempting to lower existing standards, which failed of enactment. A summary of these follows: In Arizona a bill exempting from the compulsory school attendance law the children of nonresident aliens in the State for the sole purpose of harvesting crops; in Massachusetts a bill to increase the hours of labor of females in cotton mills, which would have affected the work of minor girls; in New Hampshire a bill to exempt canning establishments from the hours of labor law; in New York bills to lower the standards of the compulsory continuation school attendance law by reducing the age for attendance or permitting the substitution of night-school attendance, and a bill permitting the employment of boys 12 and 13 years of age in certain occupations outside school hours and allowing children under 16 to work to 8 p. m. instead of 6 p. m.; in Ohio bills to lower compulsory school attendance and employment standards; in Wisconsin bills to lower standards for compulsory attendance at continuation school and for vacation employment of children under 14; in Florida and Oklahoma bills lowering standards for employment of children in theatrical performances; in Oregon a bill weakening the child labor law.

The State legislatures of 1927 and the child-labor amendment.

The State of Montana ratified the child-labor amendment to the Federal Constitution at the recent session of the legislature. The amendment was also brought before the Legislature of Nevada. The lower house, which in 1925 defeated a resolution to ratify, this year voted in favor of the amendment. The senate, however, indefinitely postponed action on the resolution. Both houses of the Legislature of Maryland voted against ratification. The Nebraska Senate also defeated a resolution to ratify the amendment by a vote of 16 to 14; the vote in the same body two years ago was 24 against and 8 for the amendment.

Recreation.

Colorado passed a measure requiring public dance halls, or other places where public dances are held, to be licensed by the boards of county commissioners, this provision not applying, however, to incorporated cities or towns. Hawaii made it unlawful for an unmarried girl under 18 to frequent a dance hall where female persons receive remuneration for acting as dancing partners, declaring any girl who attends a delinquent child and making it a misdemeanor for escort to encourage and for parent, guardian, or other person having custody of such a girl to permit violation of this provision. Iowa authorized cities and towns to limit the number of public dance halls, billiard halls, and pool rooms therein. Kansas enacted a law applicable to counties of 110,000 to 130,000 inhabitants, containing age and hour provisions and sections relating to lighting and prohibiting improper dancing and the use of return checks, and another law making it illegal to engage in the business of conducting a public dance hall, or public dances outside any incorporated city, without first taking out a license. Montana has made it a misdemeanor for

proprietors, managers, or employees of public dance halls to permit a minor under 16 years to frequent such a hall or place where such a dance is in progress unless accompanied by a parent or guardian. Pennsylvania has extended its dance hall law to cover all public dances and public dance halls in any township. One of the new provisions permits persons under 16 to attend public dances if accompanied by a parent or guardian.

In Colorado, Nebraska, Oregon, and Washington bills were introduced, but not passed, to create State motion picture censorship commissions. New Jersey bills would have authorized the creation of municipal boards of motion-picture reviewers. A New York bill would have repealed the law creating the existing State commission. A Wisconsin bill authorizing cities and villages to provide for motion-picture censorship was indefinitely postponed by the assembly.

Pennsylvania authorized second-class cities to acquire property for playgrounds, gymnasiums, swimming pools, and recreation centers within or without the corporate limits of the cities, and amended the law authorizing the taking of private property for public parks so as to permit such action for parkways and playgrounds also. Indiana and Minnesota amended their laws relating to the authority of certain cities to establish playgrounds and recreation centers.

Child hygiene.

Laws relating to county boards of health, health officers, the registration of nurses, and other public-health matters were passed in several States. A Michigan law authorizes the establishment of county health departments, the plan of organization to be approved by the State health commissioner. Such a department is to have jurisdiction throughout the county except in cities having organized health departments with full-time officers. A Montana law authorizes the boards of county commissioners of two or more adjacent counties to unite in employing a special deputy county health officer in addition to the regular county health officer. In Pennsylvania the minimum experience required of all health officers has been prescribed by law.

Birth or death registration laws were amended in Michigan, Nebraska, and New Mexico. New Jersey amended its midwifery law, including conviction for the crime of criminal abortion among the reasons for which licenses may be refused or revoked. A bill providing for the licensing and regulation of maternity homes and hospitals in Pennsylvania and bills amending such laws in Colorado and Nebraska failed to pass.

Michigan amended a law providing for free medical and surgical treatment, on order of the probate court, of children whose parents are unable to provide proper medical treatment, by authorizing such services for pregnant girls.

Measures relating to school hygiene were passed in a number of States. A new law requires physical education and training in the public schools of Arizona. Florida created the position of State supervisor of physical and health education, responsible for the supervision of such education in the public schools and for assistance in coordinating the activities of interested agencies. Illinois authorized the employment of school dentists. Indiana repealed a law passed in 1925, requiring courses in diet and nutrition in elementary and

high schools. A Kansas act authorized boards of education in first-class cities of 85,000 to 110,000 inhabitants to provide free inspection and necessary treatment of defects or ailments of public-school children unable to pay for such treatment. The New Jersey Legislature passed a bill, over the governor's veto, giving boards of education authority to employ school nurses. Texas authorized the employment by the county commissioners' courts, of public-health nurses to visit public schools, investigate health conditions of pupils, and cooperate with local boards of health and health authorities. Vermont amended the law relating to medical inspection in schools.

Physically handicapped children.

Michigan passed a comprehensive law creating a crippled children's commission, defining crippled children, and providing for the special enumeration by school census enumerators of all crippled persons under 21 years of age and for their examination, treatment, and education. New Jersey continued the crippled children's commission created in 1926.

California enacted a law providing for the registration of physically handicapped or defective persons under 21 years of age, and authorizing the department of public welfare to establish public diagnostic clinics and provide free medical services, treatment, and appliances for all such residents of the State who would otherwise be unable to obtain them. The legislature also voted to submit to the next general election a proposed amendment to the constitution authorizing State aid to certain needy physically handicapped persons. Hawaii appropriated $25,000 for the ensuing biennium for the purpose of assisting crippled school children and authorized the superintendent of public instruction to negotiate with private institutions for the purpose of securing accommodations for crippled children attending public schools and for their maintenance at such private institutions during the school year. Missouri authorized the county courts to provide for examination of indigent children under 15 with any deformity or malady as a result of such deformity that can be remedied, and to order free treatment and care for such children at the State university hospital. New York extended the law relating to physically handicapped persons so as to grant aid through the children's court to all under 21 years of age, and increased the appropriation for this purpose. Oklahoma reenacted the existing law providing for surgical treatment and hospital care for children with a deformity or a curable malady and extended its application to those under 21 years of age. Another Oklahoma law authorized the establishment of a hospital for crippled children in Oklahoma City, and made an appropriation for this purpose. Wisconsin amended the law providing for the education of deaf and blind children so as to include within its benefits all physically handicapped children.

Indiana authorized the establishment of special classes for children of school age when 10 or more with handicaps of any one type are found within any school corporation, providing for transportation to such classes and for school lunches when necessary. One section of the new act provides that no child shall be required to

undergo a medical or physical examination if his parents or guardian object thereto in writing.

California provided that whenever in any school district a sanatorium or preventorium is established for the pretuberculous and tuberculous the school district may maintain in such institution special classes for elementary, secondary, and vocational training. Massachusetts authorized counties to provide buildings and equipment for preventoriums for the treatment of children predisposed or susceptible to tuberculosis. A Minnesota law permits counties of 220,000 to 330,000 population to construct or aid in the construction of proper sanatoriums for children with tuberculosis or likely to become afflicted with tuberculosis.

A California law requires physicians, parents, and certain other persons to report to superintendents of schools the names, ages, and residence of deaf minors, and makes failure to do so a misdemeanor. It is the duty of the superintendent to communicate each child's name, age, residence, and other related information to the nearest school for the deaf. Other California laws authorize kindergarten services in connection with the California School for the Blind, vocational training of pupils attending this school, instruction of children with defective speech, and investigation and report to the next legislature upon educational facilities for the instruction of the deaf. An amendment to the Iowa law granting State aid to school corporations that provide instruction for deaf children specifies that children not of school age shall not be admitted to such instruction. Nebraska amended its law increasing the amount of State reimbursement to school districts for maintaining schools for the instruction of the deaf. Ohio transferred the custody and control of the State schools for the blind and for the deaf from the department of public welfare to the department of education.

Mentally defective children.

An Arizona bill, which passed the legislature over the governor's veto, provided for the creation of the Arizona children's colony for the care and education of mental defectives not over 21 years of age committed by the juvenile department of the superior court after examination by one or more psychiatrists or physicians. Kansas enacted a law requiring boards of education to ascertain the number of children in public schools who are three or more years retarded in their school progress, and where there are 15 or more such children a special class or special classes may be established. Minnesota granted feeble-minded persons committed by the probate court the right of appeal to the district court. Indiana, Minnesota, and Pennsylvania also amended their laws relating to the commitment of mentally defective or insane persons. Nebraska provided for the purchase of additional land for the State institution for the feeble-minded.

Indiana authorized the sterilization of insane, feeble-minded, and epileptic persons in State and county institutions. North Dakota and South Dakota amended their laws relating to the sterilization of the feeble-minded. The Governor of Colorado vetoed a bill to authorize such action. Other bills for the same purpose were introduced but were not passed in Illinois, Minnesota, Ohio, Pennsylvania, and Vermont, and an Iowa bill to reenact the existing law also

failed. Bills to repeal California laws permitting asexualization were not passed.

State welfare departments.

Until this year Florida had no State department concerned with the prevention, care, and treatment of child dependency and neglect. In 1927 a law was enacted providing for the establishment of a State board of public welfare of five members and authorizing the appointment of a secretary to be known as the commissioner of public welfare, and an assistant secretary to be known as the director of child welfare. The board of public welfare is to have general oversight of all persons placed on parole from State institutions, to encourage and assist in the development of welfare work on a county-wide basis, to license and inspect child-caring institutions and agencies, boarding homes, and maternity hospitals and homes, and to gather data concerning welfare conditions and needs in the State. An appropriation of $20,000 a year is made.

Maine changed the name of the State board of charities and corrections to the department of public welfare.

New Mexico passed an act providing for the privacy of records of the State child-welfare bureau. In New York a law was enacted requiring the head of the division of administration of institutions and the head of the division of special-welfare interests in the department of charities to be appointed and removed in accordance with civil-service rules without action by the governor.

Public aid to dependent children in their own homes.

Measures affecting the care of dependent children in their own homes were considered by a number of States. Florida amended its law to provide for aid to a mother whose husband is divorced from her or is permanently incapacitated for work by reason of mental or physical infirmity, and to any woman who is the mother of a child if her own support and the support of the child or children depend wholly or partly upon her labor. The tax levy authorized is increased, and the residence requirement in the State reduced from four years to one year.

Minnesota provided for a refund to counties of their expenditures for mothers' allowances for the last biennium (1925–1926) but accompanied this action, which is the first contribution made by the State, by repeal of that section of the law providing for State aid (this provision was added to the mothers' aid law in 1917). A Missouri amendment to the State law relating to the support of needy mothers and dependent children provided that in counties having a population of 350,000 and less than 700,000 the age limitation should be raised from 14 to 16 and the allowance increased from $10 for the first child and $5 each for other children to a maximum of $16 for the first and $8 for each additional child. This change makes the age provision uniform throughout the State except in the city of St. Louis. The State board of charities and corrections was given general supervisory powers, except in counties of 350,000 to 700,000 inhabitants. Nebraska raised from 14 to 16 years the age limitation for children entitled to benefit under the law. A New Hampshire law authorizes the State board of education to grant $2.50 per month per child additional to the regular allowance

in exceptional cases and to permit mothers receiving allowances to accept employment approved by the State board.

New York extended the application of the law providing aid for dependent children by authorizing an allowance to a mother whose husband has tuberculosis and is receiving treatment at an institution or at home and changed the citizenship requirements. The State appropriation for mothers' aid was increased in North Carolina from $30,000 to $50,000 annually for the next biennium, and in Pennsylvania from a total of $1,750,000 to a total of $2,750,000 for the next biennium. Oregon provided for the appointment of a director of mothers' pensions and an assistant in Multnomah County by the judge of the department of probate of the circuit court and included under the provisions of the mothers' pension law mothers whose husbands are inmates of county institutions or Federal prisons, as well as those in State institutions or prisons formerly provided for.

In Wisconsin a law was passed requiring investigation before a mothers' pension was granted (formerly such an investigation was optional with the judge), and another law changes the term "mothers' pension" to "aid for dependent children." A bill increasing the amount of State aid was vetoed by the Governor of Wisconsin, and a bill failed of passage which would have increased the amount of the allowance per child and extended the law to all children under 16 if conditions of dependency are present. (At present the law permits aid to children between 14 and 16 unable to obtain an employment certificate.)

Minor changes in mothers' aid laws were made in Arkansas, Illinois, Iowa, Montana, and North Dakota. The Governor of Washington vetoed the bill to redraft the mothers' aid law increasing citizenship and residence requirements, and making more stringent other eligibility requirements.

An Illinois bill to include in the mothers' allowance law a mother whose husband has been sentenced to a penitentiary, reformatory, or house of correction failed. In New Mexico, which has no mothers' aid law, a bill to provide such a system was not passed. A Maine bill which was not passed would have increased the proportion of State aid; a New York bill which failed would have authorized State aid.

Maryland amended its poor law relative to pauper children by authorizing their placement under the supervision of a child-caring agency or maintenance in their own homes, as alternatives to placement in family homes or institutions, which was previously authorized, and provided for a tax levy for this purpose.

Child-caring agencies and boarding homes.

Maryland, Pennsylvania, and Washington repealed their laws providing for indenturing or apprenticing minors. An Illinois bill for a like purpose passed the senate but was tabled by the house. Maryland passed a law requiring annual licenses to be obtained by all child-caring agencies and child-caring institutions except those receiving financial assistance from or having contracts with the State, or those licensed by an incorporated municipality or district. South Dakota authorized associations incorporated to provide care for children to receive all children surrendered in writing by parent or guardian or by order of court, provided, no child is to be placed in a

family home, for adoption or otherwise, unless surrendered to the association by a court order. New York added a section to the penal law making it a misdemeanor for a foreign corporation doing business within the State, without proper authority from the secretary of state, to carry on any kind of educational institution, lying-in asylum, home for juvenile delinquents, or institution for the care of children, or for the care and treatment of mental defectives. California passed a measure authorizing the department of finance to transport to proper homes outside the State minor orphans, abandoned children, or those with incapacitated fathers, with the proviso that the county from which a child is removed pay one-half the expense incurred by the State. The defeat of Pennsylvania bills relating to child placing has been noted in the discussion of child-welfare commissions (see p. 23). The Governor of Iowa vetoed a bill amending the definition of boarding homes. Other bills amending laws relating to boarding homes and child-caring and child-placing agencies failed to pass in California, Colorado, New York, and South Dakota.

Adoption and guardianship.

California amended its adoption law, providing for investigation by the department of public welfare unless a licensed child-placing agency is a party to the adoption proceedings, for privacy of records of adoption cases, and for written relinquishments by the parents. Iowa repealed its law relating to adoption, passing a comprehensive new measure which provides for investigation and six months' residence in the proposed adoptive home. Oregon amended the provision which states that adoption terminates the relation of parent and child, by specifically excepting cases in which a parent marries the person adopting. South Dakota made it compulsory for the county court, upon receipt of an adoption petition, to direct an investigation of the matter before hearing, requiring also a minimum period of six months' residence in the proposed foster home before the granting of the petition. Vermont made it compulsory for probate courts to investigate conditions and circumstances attending proposed adoption before accepting instruments of adoption for filing. (The features of the new adoption law of Georgia are given on p. 23.)

Kansas, Maine, Michigan, Oklahoma, Washington, and Wyoming amended their laws relating to consents required for the adoption of minors. Colorado and Minnesota made slight changes in their laws. A New Mexico bill weakening the adoption law failed to pass, and one repealing the adoption law in Pennsylvania died in committee.

Delaware and Maine passed laws declaring mothers and fathers equal guardians of their minor children. A similar New York bill died in committee. Massachusetts, New York, Oklahoma, Texas, Vermont, Washington, and Wisconsin also amended their guardianship laws.

Juvenile and domestic-relations courts.

In Connecticut the powers and duties in relation to children that are exercised by officials of town, city, borough, and police courts as juvenile-court officials were conferred upon justices of the peace and probate judges in towns having none of the four types of court previously mentioned. Idaho amended the law governing procedure in juvenile cases, the changes including a requirement that commitment

must be with the consent of parent or guardian or on the finding of the court that the child has no living parents or guardian or that the parents or guardian are unfit or are neglecting the child. Investigation by the court is required. A Michigan law extends the provisions of the juvenile court act to wayward minors between the ages of 17 and 21 years, defining wayward minors and amending the law in other particulars. In Ohio laws were enacted creating divisions of domestic relations, with juvenile and domestic-relations jurisdiction, in the common-pleas courts of Franklin and Stark Counties.

Florida increased the jurisdiction of the court over contributory dependency or contributory delinquency to include any person charged therewith; formerly the law applied only to parent or guardian or person having custody. Florida also created a new juvenile court in Pinellas County, amended the law relative to Dade County by giving the juvenile judge the powers of a committing magistrate, and raised the salary of the judge in Duval County from $600 to $3,000 a year. A law was passed in Massachusetts providing that when children over 14 are committed to jail to await trial or examination they must be returned to court within three days after each such commitment, and their cases must be disposed of in some manner not later than 10 days after the original commitment. A child so committed must be kept separate and apart from committed persons 17 years of age and over. Texas requires counties with a population of more than 50,000 (instead of 100,000 as formerly) to provide suitable places of detention for juveniles separate and apart from any jail or lockup in which older persons are confined.

The most important of several amendments to the juvenile court law in Minnesota were that (1) juvenile jurisdiction once obtained should continue until the child reaches the age of 19 years (formerly 18 years) and (2) the fact that a child has been adjudged delinquent more than once (formerly more than twice) is prima facie evidence of contributory delinquency on the part of the parent or guardian. A Nevada law requires the exclusion of minors from criminal trials unless they are on trial or testifying as witnesses, or are law students. Wyoming, which has no juvenile court law, has made it a misdemeanor to cause or encourage the delinquency of any child under the full age of 18 years.

Laws weakening juvenile-court administration were passed in Massachusetts and Missouri. The former provided for appeal to the superior court by a child adjudged wayward or delinquent at the time of commitment or sentence as well as upon adjudication. Missouri made transfer of proceedings involving delinquent children from other courts or magistrates to juvenile courts discretionary instead of mandatory, such other courts or magistrates being given power to deny petitions or motions for transfer. Juvenile judges throughout the State (instead of in counties of less than 50,000 population only, as formerly) are authorized to dismiss juvenile proceedings and permit the child to be prosecuted under general law, when he does not appear to be a proper subject for juvenile-court procedure.

Probation.

A probation system in all courts of the State except justice of the peace courts has been provided by a West Virginia law. Probation laws were amended in California, Florida, Indiana, Iowa,

Kansas, Massachusetts, Minnesota, Nebraska, New Jersey, and Texas. In Michigan a bill was passed to revise and codify all State laws relating to criminal procedure and criminal jurisdiction of the courts, and to establish a uniform probation system throughout the State. New Jersey created a commission for the study of probation laws and procedure. A similar commission was provided for in a California bill which did not receive the governor's approval. A bill introduced but not passed in Pennsylvania would have established a probation bureau in the department of welfare.

A judicial council to carry on continuous study of the administration of justice has been authorized in North Dakota, its members to be judges, lawyers, and others. Laws providing for the establishment of penal and crime commissions were enacted in Illinois, Ohio, Pennsylvania, and Rhode Island.

Institutions for juvenile delinquents.

A State school for delinquent girls was provided for in Arizona. Hitherto boys and girls have been cared for in the same institution. Under the terms of a new Indiana law, boys 16 and under 21 years not previously convicted of felony but found guilty of the commission of a crime punishable by commitment to the reformatory are to be committed to the reformatory under an indeterminate sentence of 1 to 10 years, or to the Indiana State Farm for any indeterminate period not exceeding 1 year. A Missouri law reserves the Missouri reformatory to boys under 21 (formerly men up to 30 were admitted), and another law creates an intermediate reformatory for young men 17 years and under 25 convicted of felony for the first time and not guilty of treason or murder in the first or second degree or any other capital offense. In New Mexico the name of the "reform school" was changed to "industrial school," and the classes of boys received were enlarged to include those under 18 convicted of any offense less than murder or manslaughter. Texas provided for a State training school for delinquent and dependent colored girls, and amended the law relating to training schools for boys.

County adjustment schools for minors under the age of 18 years are authorized by a California law, and the establishment of elementary and secondary public schools in detention homes is also authorized. In Illinois the amount of taxes which counties may levy for the establishment and maintenance of detention homes for children has been decreased.

Offenses against children.

Hawaii increased the penalty for assault with intent to rape, providing for a fine of not more than $1,000 and imprisonment at hard labor for life or any number of years. Indiana amended the law defining rape in the first and second degrees and providing penalties. Iowa passed an act making five years' imprisonment the minimum punishment for rape and authorizing parole if less than the maximum penalty has been imposed. Michigan amended the law which makes it a felony for a male over 16 years, without committing or intending to commit rape, to assault a female under 16 years; formerly the age was over 14 for the male and under 14 for the female. The Minnesota law making it a felony to take indecent liberties with a

girl under 14 has been amended to include boys and girls under 16 regardless of consent. New York has made it a felony punishable by not more than 10 years' imprisonment for any male over 18 to take indecent liberties with a girl of 10 years or less.

Nonsupport of children.

Maine passed a law permitting appeal by either party in a nonsupport case. Nebraska made it a felony for a person against whom a decree for alimony has been issued to fail to support his children. New York authorized the children's court in nonsupport cases to require security by bond or undertaking for the performance of court orders. Oregon included abandonment under the terms of its nonsupport law and provided that leaving the State and failing to provide proper shelter, food, and so forth, for wife or child within 60 days shall constitute prima facie evidence of desertion and abandonment. The Governor of Michigan vetoed a bill to omit from the nonsupport and desertion act the provisions making neglect or refusal to support a felony and the provision relative to defendant's bond, and to add a provision that a divorce or divorce proceedings should not bar prosecution under the act. In Nevada and New Mexico bills to amend nonsupport acts, including provisions making the offense a felony, were not passed.

In California, Idaho, Kansas, and Washington laws relating to compensation to prisoners' families during the term of imprisonment were amended.

Children born out of wedlock.

Connecticut amended the law relating to the support of children born out of wedlock, providing that the selectmen of the town of residence of a child for whom an order of support has been issued shall have general supervision of the child during the continuance of the order. The Hawaii law relating to children born out of wedlock but legitimated through the subsequent marriage of their parents was amended by a provision that any such child is to take the family name of his father and may have his birth record amended to make birth legitimate and to show such name. Bills based on provisions of the Uniform Illegitimacy Act failed to become law in Georgia, Michigan, and Wyoming.

Marriage laws.

Minnesota raised from 15 to 16 the minimum marriage age of girls, permitting the juvenile-court judge, after investigation, to authorize the granting of a license to a girl of 15. Pennsylvania raised the minimum age of marriage after October, 1927, to 16 years for both parties, with a proviso that the judge of the orphans' court, in his discretion, may permit the issuance of certificates to persons under 16. A Pennsylvania bill, which was vetoed by the governor, would have permitted the minor party or parties to a marriage for which the license was illegally procured and to which no children had been born to have the marriage declared void. New York enacted a law making it compulsory for the clerk issuing the marriage licenses to require documentary proof of age of persons under 21. California passed a measure requiring publication or posting of a notice of intention to marry at least 10 days and not more than 30 days prior to the application for a license.

The Governor of Oregon vetoed a bill to repeal the 1925 law which declares that when two persons cohabit for more than one year and children are born as the result of such cohabitation the parties shall be deemed married. The Governor of Wisconsin vetoed a bill to amend the marriage law by omitting the requirement that county clerks must post notice of application for a marriage license.

In addition to those already noted, bills to increase marriage restrictions in regard to age, consent, health requirements, and publication of notice, or in regard to stated intervals between application for and granting of licenses, were introduced but failed to become law in Arizona, California, Idaho, Illinois, Iowa, Kansas, Maine, Minnesota, Nevada, New Hampshire, New York, North Carolina, Ohio, Oregon, Pennsylvania, South Dakota, Washington, and West Virginia.

EXHIBITS

The Children's Bureau work in exhibits has been expanded and improved during the past year. New material added includes 75 new wall panels, two new models—"Posture" and "Sun Baths for Babies"—and a mechanical book. A film, Sun Babies, was completed in March, 1927. Seven additional prints of the Posture film were purchased to meet the constant demand for this film. Twenty-five copies of the film, Sun Babies, issued in March, 1927, and 28 copies of the Posture film, issued in 1926, have been sold to public and private health agencies during the past year.

Exhibits have been sent on request to National, State, and local agencies, including the American Medical Association and other medical societies, boards of health, public-health organizations, social-service organizations, the American Red Cross, child-welfare societies, fraternal societies, educational institutions, Young Men's and Young Women's Christian Associations, Boy Scout troops, Camp Fire Girls, women's clubs, fairs and expositions, and religious organizations. A total of 472 exhibit shipments were made during the year, including 1,556 lantern slides, 50 strips of film slides, 503 reels of motion pictures, 2,985 wall panels, 21 projectors, and 24 models.

Thirty-one requests for future loans were on file on July 1, 1927, some of the material being scheduled for exhibits in November and December, 1927.

Sesquicentennial International Exposition.

A special appropriation enabled the Children's Bureau to participate in the Government exhibit at the Sesquicentennial Exposition in Philadelphia. The main features of the bureau's exhibit included a child-health conference and posture demonstrations, models of a nursery and a playground, a baby's fashion show, and motion pictures and film slides of various phases of child welfare. Three hundred and fifty children were examined at the health conference, and during the last month of the exposition 700 children were weighed and measured. In the center of the exhibit and emblematic of the work of the Children's Bureau was a large mural painting entitled "The Child Shall Be First." A medal of honor was awarded the bureau for the entire exhibit, and a gold medal for the painting.

REPORTS ISSUED, IN PRESS, AND IN PREPARATION

During the fiscal year 1927, 46 new and revised publications were issued. Six were in press at the close of the fiscal year and 26 in preparation.

Reports issued during the fiscal year ended June 30, 1927:

Fourteenth Annual Report of the Chief, Children's Bureau, 1926.

The Promotion of the Welfare and Hygiene of Maternity and Infancy—The Administration of the Act of Congress of November 23, 1921, Fiscal Year Ended June 30, 1925. No. 156.

Proceedings of the Third Annual Conference of State Directors in Charge of the Local Administration of the Maternity and Infancy Act of November 23, 1921. No. 157.

- Separate No. 1. The Physician's Part in a Practical State Program of Prenatal Care, by Fred L. Adair, M. D. Standards of Prenatal Care, by Robert L. De Normandie, M. D.
- Separate No. 2. The Nurse's Part in a State Program of Prenatal Care, by Carolyn Conant Van Blarcom, R. N.
- Separate No. 3. How to Make a Study of Maternal Mortality, by Robert L. De Normandie, M. D.
- Separate No. 4. A Demonstration of the Community Control of Rickets, by Martha M. Eliot, M. D.
- Separate No. 5. Stimulation of Birth Registration, by William H. Davis, M. D.
- Separate No. 6. The Practical Application of Mental Hygiene to the Welfare of the Child, by D. A. Thom, M. D.
- Separate No. 7. Nutrition in Relation to Reproduction and Vitality of the Offspring, by Nina Simmonds, Sc. D.

Maternal Mortality; the risk of death in childbirth and from all diseases caused by pregnancy and confinement, by Robert Morse Woodbury, Ph. D. No. 158.

A Study of Maternity Homes in Minnesota and Pennsylvania. No. 167.

Infant Care, revised. No. 8.

Posture Clinics; organization and exercises, by Armin Klein, M. D. No. 164.

Posture Exercises; a handbook for schools and for teachers of physical education, by Armin Klein, M. D., and Leah C. Thomas. No. 165.

Milk, the Indispensable Food for Children, by Dorothy Reed Mendenhall, M. D. No. 163.

What Is Malnutrition? By Lydia J. Roberts. (Revised.) No. 59.

Child Labor in the United States—Ten Questions Answered. Fourth Edition. No. 114.

Physical Standards for Working Children (appendix revised to include legislation to August 15, 1926). No. 79.

Work of Children on Illinois Farms, by Dorothy M. Williams and Mary E. Skinner. No. 168.

Child Labor—Outlines for Study. Fifth Edition. No. 93.

Dependent and Delinquent Children in North Dakota and South Dakota; a study of the prevalence, treatment, and prevention of child dependency and delinquency in two rural States. No. 160.

Reports issued during the fiscal year ended June 30, 1927—Continued.

Dependent and Delinquent Children in Georgia; a study of the prevalence and treatment of child dependency and delinquency in thirty counties, with special reference to legal protection needed. No. 161.

Child Welfare Conditions and Resources in Seven Pennsylvania Counties, by Neva R. Deardorff, Ph. D. No. 176.

Separate. The Extent of Child Dependency and Delinquency in Seven Pennsylvania Counties, by Neva R. Deardorff, Ph. D.

Public Aid to Mothers with Dependent Children; extent and fundamental principles, by Emma O. Lundberg. No. 162.

Children of Illegitimate Birth and Measures for Their Protection, by Emma O. Lundberg. No. 166.

The County as a Unit for an Organized Program of Child-Caring and Protective Work, by Emma O. Lundberg. No. 169.

Handbook for the Use of Boards of Directors, Superintendents, and Staffs of Institutions for Dependent Children. No. 170.

The Work of Child-Placing Agencies. Part 1.—A Social Study of Ten Agencies Caring for Dependent Children, by Katharine P. Hewins and L. Josephine Webster. Part 2.—Health Supervision of Children Placed in Foster Homes, by Mary L. Evans, M. D. No. 171.

Public Child-Caring Work in Certain Counties of Minnesota, North Carolina, and New York, by H. Ida Curry. No. 173.

Child Welfare in New Jersey. Part 1.—State Supervision and Personnel Administration, by William J. Blackburn. No. 174.

Child Welfare in New Jersey. Part 2.—State Provision for Dependent Children, by Ruth Berolzheimer and Florence Nesbitt. No. 175.

Recreation for Blind Children, by Martha Travilla Speakman. No. 172.

Charts, dodgers, folders, and leaflets issued during the fiscal year ended June 30, 1927:

Breast Feeding. Folder No. 8.

Baby's Daily Time Cards (six cards giving daily routine and training for babies from birth to 2 years of age). Chart No. 14.

Is Your Child's Birth Recorded? Dodger No. 3. Revised December 1, 1926.

Books and Pamphlets on Child Care (revised September 1, 1926). Dodger No. 1.

What Is the Future of the Day Nursery? By Grace Abbott. (Reprinted from Child Health Bulletin, Vol. III, No. 2, February, 1927.)

Sunlight for Babies. Folder No. 5.

From School to Work. Folder No. 6.

Community Care of Dependent, Delinquent, and Handicapped Children. Folder No. 7.

Progressive Methods of Care of Children Pending Juvenile Court Hearing, by Katharine F. Lenroot. (Reprinted from Hospital Social Service, XV, 1927, 46.)

Charts, dodgers, folders, and leaflets issued during the fiscal year ended June 30, 1927—Continued.

The Federal Children's Bureau at the Sesquicentennial, by Samuel McClintock Hamill, M. D. (Reprinted from Child Health Bulletin, Vol. II, No. 5, November, 1926.)
List of Publications, January 3, 1927.
Ground Plan for Cottage Institution for Dependent Children.

Reports in press at close of fiscal year ended June 30, 1927:

Keeping the Well Baby Well. Folder No. 9.
The Promotion of the Welfare and Hygiene of Maternity and Infancy—The Administration of the Act of Congress of November 23, 1921, Fiscal Year Ended June 30, 1926.[10]
References on the Physical Growth and Development of the Normal Child.
Child Welfare in New Jersey. Part 4.—Local Provision for Dependent and Delinquent Children in Relation to the State Program.
The Children's Bureau of Cleveland.[11]
John and Elsie posters (a set of 12 posters showing child-labor standards).

Reports in preparation at close of the fiscal year ended June 30, 1927:

Annual Report of the Chief, Children's Bureau, 1927.
The Promotion of the Welfare and Hygiene of Maternity and Infancy—The Administration of the Act of Congress of November 23, 1921, Fiscal Year Ended June 30, 1927.
Proceedings of the Fourth Annual Conference of State Directors in Charge of the Local Administration of the Maternity and Infancy Act of November 23, 1921.
Child Care, revised (Publication No. 30).
Child Management, revised September 1, 1927 (Publication No. 143).
The Incidence of Rickets among a Group of Children under Four Years of Age in Washington, D. C.
Incidence of Rickets in Children in Porto Rico.
The Care of the Preschool Child (folder).
Relation of Posture to Physical Fitness.
Study of Rickets in Children, New Haven.
Administration of Laws Exempting Children from School Attendance for Work at Home.
Child Labor in Canneries.
Child Labor in New Jersey, Part 1.—Administration of Child Labor Laws.
Child Labor in New Jersey, Part 2.—Industrial Home Work.
Child Labor in New Jersey, Part 3.—Work of Children in Vacation and before and after School.
Children in Agriculture.
Children in Street Work.
Vocational Opportunities for Minors in Selected Industries.
Work Opportunities for Young Persons of Subnormal Mentality, Part 1.
The Child, the Family, and the Court.

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[10] Issued in August. [11] Issued in July.

Reports in preparation at close of the fiscal year ended June 30, 1927—Cont'd.

Child Welfare in New Jersey, Part 3.—State Provision for the Care of Delinquent Children.

Children of Illegitimate Birth Who Have Been Reared by Relatives.

Delinquency among Chicago Boys above Juvenile-Court Age.

Crippled Children, with Special Reference to Programs for Their Treatment and Education in Ten States.

The Welfare of Prisoners' Families in Kentucky.

Public Dance Halls, Their Regulation and Place in the Recreation of Adolescents.

DISTRIBUTION OF PUBLICATIONS

During the past year the bureau distributed 1,306,064 publications, including folders, dodgers, and popular bulletins. This figure is less than that of the year before (1,687,181) for two reasons: (1) In 1926 two very brief bulletins for the maternity and infant-hygiene division were distributed to the very large number of 300,000; and (2) the total distribution of popular bulletins was approximately 100,000 less than in 1926 because the special printing fund of $7,500 available for popular bulletins in 1926 was not appropriated for 1927. Inasmuch as Child Care was being revised, the necessary curtailment was effected chiefly through a drastic cut in the distribution of the old edition of that bulletin. Of the popular bulletins in the child-care series, the numbers distributed were as follows: Infant Care, 335,235; Prenatal Care, 166,399; Child Care, 60,520; Child Management, 63,912. The sales of these bulletins by the Superintendent of Documents amounted to 237,000 in 1926, and the number ordered for sale in 1927 was 280,000. Altogether about 7,400,000 of these four bulletins have been distributed and sold since they were published. A set of six cards on the care of the baby, called Baby's Daily Time Cards, was issued in October and has proved very popular, 22,000 sets having been distributed. The four new folders issued during the year were also sent out in large numbers: Sunlight for Babies (Folder No. 5), 78,060; From School to Work (Folder No. 6), 19,772; Community Care of Dependent, Delinquent, and Handicapped Children (Folder No. 7), 17,653; and Breast Feeding (Folder No. 8), 53,965. The total distribution of folders and dodgers was 452,184. Of the reports of bureau investigation, legal research, etc., approximately 178,000 copies were distributed.

Instead of sending the more expensive publications automatically to the mailing lists, the bureau has extended its practice of circularizing the lists before sending the publications. This was done for 15 of the 46 new publications issued during the year. This is only one of the ways in which the bureau has attempted to use its small printing fund to the best advantage. With every precaution against waste in publication methods and in distribution, and with increased sales, it is still impossible to meet the demand for the bureau's publications. In the next fiscal year the situation will be somewhat improved through the additional sum of $5,000 made available by Congress for

popular bulletins; but this will by no means enable the bureau to keep up with the demand.

In addition to information supplied through publications, the bureau replies to many letters requesting advice. Last year 120,760 letters were received, an increase of 13,252 over the year before.

The Child Welfare News Summary was issued thirty times during the year. The summary is sent on request only to persons who are actively engaged in child-welfare work and to child-welfare agencies and publications. On July 1, 1926, there were 1,075 names on the list; during the year 73 names have been added.

GENERAL DEVELOPMENT OF THE WORK OF THE BUREAU

In the last annual report attention was called to the need of increasing the bureau's resources for research and consultation with reference to delinquency and its prevention. Evidence of this need has accumulated during the past year. At present such work as is done in this field by the social-service division of the Children's Bureau must compete with requests for studies of mothers' pensions, orphanages, child-placing agencies, and other problems connected with dependency and neglect. There is a growing appreciation of the fact that crime has its beginning in the delinquencies of children and that we are paying too much for the care and punishment of criminals and too little for the prevention of crime. Careful study is the foundation upon which a program of prevention must be built.

To meet the present demands which come to the bureau a division devoted entirely to delinquency and its prevention is needed. For such a division an annual appropriation of approximately $50,000 should be made. It is to be hoped that the creation of this division, which is so clearly in the interest of national economy, will be found possible.

The Children's Bureau is under great obligation for much valuable, unpaid assistance during the past year. Reference has been made to the committee of obstetricians which has assisted in working out plans for a maternal-mortality study. The pediatric committee, which is composed of representatives appointed by the pediatric section of the American Medical Association, the American Pediatric Society, and the American Child Health Association, has advised with the director of the child-hygiene division of the bureau about research undertakings and has offered helpful criticisms of reports and popular bulletins. Directors of State departments of public welfare and other public and private agencies, and also other Government bureaus have assisted by reading reports, lending personnel, and in other ways. In the same spirit of cooperation the bureau has responded to many requests for help and local consultation on child-welfare problems of which no mention can be made in this brief summary of its activities.

Respectfully submitted.

GRACE ABBOTT, *Chief.*

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